

TOPIC 9: Post-War Philippines

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Introduction to the Post-War Philippines, 1945-1965

The following section of historical sources includes documents and speeches from the term of presidents of the Philippines as well as noted statesmen under the postwar Philippines. Coming from the devastation of the Second World War in 1945, this period starts with the rehabilitation of the country alongside its independence of the Philippines from United States as a sovereign nation-state in 1946. The period which starts from year 1945 to 1964 with the presidencies of Sergio Osmena, Manuel Roxas, Elpidio Quirino, Ramon Magsaysay, Carlos Garcia, and Diosdado Macapagal. This period in Philippine history can be characterized with the issues that pressed on with the nation-state as it was rebuilding itself from the economic impact of the war, the political turmoil that occurred internally with the insurgencies, and the changing alignments within the diplomatic arena in time of the Cold War.

This section includes presidential inaugural addresses, the state of the nation addresses, and other landmark speeches that defined the presidencies of Osmena, Roxas, Quirino, Magsaysay, Garcia, and Macapagal. These selections offer the range of issues that can characterize the issues that were relevant during the period which include postwar rehabilitation, defense against insurgencies, diplomatic alignment with the United States and other countries, agrarian land reform, economic and cultural nationalism among others. Aside from these documents, documents from prominent nationalist statesmen such as Claro Recto and Carlos Romulo are included to show perspectives prevailing within the same issues that beset the nation-state. In reading these documents, it can provide an understanding of the continuities and changes that occurred during this time when the nation-state was rebuilding itself alongside its own nation-building as an independent sovereign state.

Sergio Osmeña, State of the Nation Address, June 9, 1945

Popularly known as the "Grand Old Man of Cebu," Sergio Osmeña (September 9, 1878 - October 19, 1961) served as the President of the Commonwealth of the Philippines succeeding Manuel L. Quezon after the latter's death in 1944. Osmeña returned to the Philippines with General Douglas MacArthur and his soldiers on October 20, 1944. He then headed the Commonwealth government that was re-established temporarily in Tacloban, Leyte on October 23, 1944.

In the wake of the Japanese defeat, Osmeña reorganized the government in response to the needs of the country. On March 7, 1945, he signed an Executive Order which provided the restoration of the executive departments before the war. On June 9, Osmeña called a session of Congress where he delivered his first and only State of the Nation Address at the provisional quarters in an old school building at Lepanto Street in Manila. Osmeña delivered a comprehensive report on the work done by the Commonwealth government for three years in Washington, DC. He also described the social conditions in the Philippines during the war and acknowledged the valuable help provided by the Filipino guerrillas to the American forces in the liberation of the Philippines.

Excerpt:

**Message
of
His Excellency Sergio Osmeña
President of the Philippines
To the Congress
On the State of the Nation**

[Delivered on June 9, 1945]

GENTLEMEN OF THE CONGRESS:

Today, a moment of great historic significance, the voice of our people, muted throughout the long dreary night of enemy enslavement, is to be heard again in the halls of this Congress, through their duly elected representatives.

It has been a long lapse of time since that day in November, 1941, when you were elected, to this day when you gather in your first session. We can hardly recognize our country after the cataclysm that has engulfed it. The war has left its livid scars everywhere—on our buildings as

well as on men's souls. Probably nothing can more starkly summarize our present plight than the fact that the Executive and Legislative branches of our Government have to meet today in a borrowed house because our Legislative Building is a heap of rubble and ashes, mute witness to the savage desperation of the beaten enemy.

The tragedy that has afflicted our nation has lacerated our hearts. We all miss today many dear and familiar faces that are no more. But perhaps no sorrow has touched us more deeply than the passing of our beloved leader, Manuel L. Quezon. I know, however, that you feel as I do that his immortal spirit abides with us in this hour of trial and crisis, encouraging us to proceed with the arduous tasks that lie ahead. This great man, who dedicated his entire life to his country, died as he would have wanted to die—in line of duty. Soon his mortal remains, kept at the Arlington National Cemetery at Virginia, will be brought back to the Philippines, and we shall all have the opportunity of rendering him our last homage of admiration and affection. We shall erect him a monument so that we and our generations yet unborn may keep his memory enshrined in our hearts.

The Philippines is the one territory under the American flag which has suffered the most at the invader's hands. Not only are its war casualties the highest in proportion to population, not only have its cities and towns been destroyed and looted, its countrysides and farms laid waste, and its whole economic structure ruined, but its people have undergone more physical pain and mental anguish than in any other part of the United States. As early as December 8, 1941, a few hours after her felon attack on Pearl Harbor, Japan sent bombers and task forces to the Philippines. Unavoidably turned into a battlefield, our country suffered heavily in men and property, especially in Bataan, where the Filipino-American Army battled the Japanese forces for four long months.

Then followed a period of enemy occupation, cruel and humiliating. No sooner had the fighting in Bataan ended than the enemy began the systematic looting of our country. There was no limit to what he could requisition with his worthless money. Even our barest necessities were commandeered. And when we tried to stand by our rights, force, ruthless force, immediately intervened. With or without cause, people by the scores were arrested and sent to prison and concentration camps—some to be tortured, others to be executed. As time went on, we became more impoverished, while the enemy became still more cruel and arrogant. After undergoing three years of enemy domination, no people was a more pitiful sight than the Filipinos—lean, ragged and famished.

I wish to stress the fact that the extreme suffering of the Filipinos and the widespread destruction wrought on our country has been due, in a large measure, to their unwavering loyalty to the United States. No people, I believe, has given so much proof of fidelity to the cause of the mother country as the Filipinos.

... Unwilling to bow to the enemy, the Filipino people valiantly took up the struggle with all the strength they could muster. Patriotic groups soon sprang up throughout the length and breadth of the Archipelago. At first eluding the enemy, the guerrillas took to the mountains, but with the active support of the civilian population they quickly grew in number and strength to become a virtual challenge to the enemy. The story of the guerrilleros and of the civilian patriots who helped them, is an epic of heroism, loyalty and sacrifice. As far as possible they should be given recognition. Recognized guerrilla units have already been incorporated into the Philippine Army. As stated in Leyte, in praising the guerrillas we should not be forgetful of the loyal civilians who were left behind and, at the risk of their lives, supported the resistance movement. Included among these civilians were those who, at the beginning of the war, were civil service employees or holders of subordinate positions in the government, and who remained at their posts to protect the people and extend to them all possible aid and comfort. They should, as a general principle, be recalled as soon as their services should be needed; only for strong reasons should they be deprived of their privilege to serve. This policy applies as well to elected provincial and municipal officials who were chosen in the election of 1940, thus giving due consideration to the will of the people as expressed at the polls.

... But the tasks of peace are at times more exacting than those of war. We are administering the affairs of eighteen million people just delivered from three long years of enslavement. To them we owe justice, order and the means to live in contentment and happiness. I am aware that our means at the moment are inadequate. We are not able to provide our people with as much as they deserve. But we shall not falter in the line of duty.

Let us get together in one mighty effort. Let us set aside selfish considerations and forget petty differences. Only in unity can there be strength. To the experienced, I turn for advice. From the youth of the land, I ask for its enthusiasm and energies. My faith in our people is unbounded. Over the ruins of our cities and barrios we shall build anew. In this most crucial hour of our history, I look forward to our destiny unafraid, confident that, God willing, ours will be a happy, progressive and prosperous land.

In closing, permit me to congratulate you most heartily for being the first elective Congress to meet in a country liberated from the enemy, although the Philippines is among the last to be free from enemy occupation and control.

I wish you all success in discharging the tremendous responsibility that is yours during the present emergency.

Republic Act No. 1400

Land Reform Act of 1955

An Act Defining a Land Tenure Policy, Providing for an Instrumentality to Carry out the Policy, and appropriating for its implementation.

Ramon Magsaysay, the third President of the Third Republic announced during his first State of the Nation Address that agriculture would be a priority of his administration. He aimed for farmers' education particularly in modern agricultural methods and called for the improvement of irrigation systems to improve farm production. Known as the "People's President" and the "Champion of Philippine Agriculture," Magsaysay implemented programs and policies to improve agriculture and empower rural communities which are important to national recovery.

One of the enacted laws about land reform during the Magsaysay administration was the Republic Act No. 1400 also known as the Land Reform Act of 1955. This created the Land Tenure Administration (LTA) which has the the following functions: (1) make studies on the land tenure problems throughout the Philippines and prepare over-all long range plans to solve problems; (2) initiate immediate investigation in areas reporting land tenure difficulties and recommend appropriate action and; (3) prepare a plan for the systematic opening of virgin lands of the public domain for distribution to tenants.

Excerpt:

SECTION 1. *Short title.*—This Act shall be known as the “Land Reform Act of 1955.”

SEC. 2. *Declaration of policy.*—It is the declared policy of the State to create and maintain an agrarian system which is peaceful, prosperous and stable, and to this end the Government shall establish and distribute as many family-size farms to as many landless citizens as possible through the opening up of public agricultural lands and the division and distribution of private agricultural lands where agrarian conflicts exist, either by private arrangement with the owners or through expropriation proceedings.

SEC 3. *Creation and composition.*—For the purpose of carrying out the policy enunciated in this Act, there is hereby created a Land Tenure Administration, hereinafter called the Administration, which shall be directly under the control and supervision of and responsible to the President of the Philippines. The Administration shall consist of a Chairman and two members who shall be appointed by the President with the consent of the Commission on Appointments and shall hold office for a period of five years. They may be removed for cause or for incapacity to discharge the duties of their office.

SEC. 4. *Qualifications and compensation of members.*—No person shall be appointed Chairman or member of the Administration unless he is natural born citizen of the Philippines, at least thirty-five years of age, and not related by affinity or consanguinity within the fourth civil degree to any landowner who may be affected by this Act.

The Chairman shall receive an annual compensation of fifteen thousand pesos and the members shall each receive an annual compensation of twelve thousand pesos.

SEC. 5. *Functions.*—It shall be the responsibility of the Administration to:

- (1) Make studies on the land tenure problems throughout the Philippines, prepare over-all long range plans to solve such problems, and keep the President and the Congress of the Philippines full informed of the progress of the land tenure reform program;
- (2) Initiate immediate investigation in areas reporting land tenure difficulties and recommend appropriate action without delay;
- (3) Inform the President and the Congress of the Philippines of any deficiency of the other departments or agencies of the Government in the implementation of legislation bearing on or affecting the land tenure reform;
- (4) Prepare a plan for the systematic opening of virgin lands of the public domain for distribution to tenants, preference to be given to those tenants who are ejected by virtue of mechanization and to other landless citizens; and
- (5) To implement and carry out the expropriation and the resale or lease of urban lands already authorized by existing laws.

NEGOTIATED PURCHASE OF PRIVATE AGRICULTURAL LANDS

SEC. 11. *Lands subject to purchase.*—The Administration, acting for and on behalf of the Government, may negotiate to purchase any privately owned agricultural land when the majority of the tenants therein petition for such purchase.

SEC. 12. *Action on the petition.*—Upon receipt of the petition, the Administration shall;

- (1) Within thirty days, determine on the basis of the information contained in the petition, the suitability of the land for purchase, notify the petitioners and the landowner accordingly, and fix the date for preliminary negotiations;
- (2) Within sixty days from the preliminary negotiation, conduct investigations and technical surveys to determine title to the land and its real value, taking into account (a) the prevailing prices of similar lands in the immediate area, (b) the soil conditions topography and climate hazards, (c) actual production, (d) accessibility, and (e) improvements; and
- (3) Fix, within ninety days from the preliminary negotiation, the date for final negotiation.

SEC. 13. *Deposit by tenants.*—Before fixing the date for final negotiation under section twelve, paragraph (3), and in the interest of public welfare, the Administration shall require the tenants to form a cooperative to be affiliated with a government financing cooperative agency. Such cooperative agency shall deposit with the Administration an amount not exceeding twenty-five *per centum* of the annual gross produce of the principal crop or crops of such land on the basis of the average of harvest of the three years immediately preceding the year the petition was filed. This deposit shall be credited to the selling price to the tenants in accordance with the individual contribution of each said deposit.

SEC. 14. *Payment.*—In negotiating for the purchase of agricultural land, the Administration shall offer to pay the purchase price wholly in land certificates or partly in legal tender and partly in

land certificates: *Provided*, That the amount to be paid in legal tender shall in no case exceed fifty *per centum* of the purchase price: *Provided, further*, That the landowner, if he desires and the Administration so agrees, may be paid, by way of barter or exchange, with such residential, commercial or industrial land owned by the Government as may be agreed upon by the parties.

SEC. 15. *Outstanding debts of tenants*.—In cases where the landowner is willing to accept payment wholly in land certificates, the Administration is authorized to include in the price to be paid the landowner all the outstanding debts, evidenced in writing, of the tenants to said landowner, the Administration to be thereafter reimbursed in accordance with such rules and regulations as it may promulgate: *Provided*, That the resulting increase in price by virtue of such inclusion will not be more than ten *per centum* of the total cost of the land agreed upon in the negotiated sale.

Approved, September 9, 1955.

Carlos P. Garcia, Third State of the Nation Address, January 25, 1960

Carlos P. Garcia (November 4, 1896 - June 14, 1971) assumed Presidency after the sudden death of Ramon Magsaysay in 1957 and was elected for a full four-year term on the same year. Before becoming the President of the country, Garcia was concurrently the Vice President and the Secretary of Foreign Affairs from 1953-1957. He was the Representative of the Third District of Bohol (1925-1931) and was a Senator under the Roxas and Quirino administration.

Garcia's Presidency is known through its Filipino First Policy as a response to America's economic dominance in the Philippines during the postwar period. This policy aimed to assert Filipino role in the country's economy by prioritizing Filipino-owned businesses and patronizing Filipino-made products.

In this message of President Garcia on the State of the Nation in 1960, he explained the significance of the Filipino First Policy "to regain economic independence" which will lead to the country's economic progress. Garcia instituted the policy with the National Economic Council issuing Resolution No. 204 on August 21, 1958. Aside from economic nationalism, Garcia also mentioned other important focus of his administration which include: rural development; development of new foreign markets; education and science; National Defense; Public works; and health.

Excerpt:

**Message
of
His Excellency Carlos P. Garcia
President of the Philippines
To the Congress
On the State of the Nation**

[Delivered on January 25, 1960]

Mr. Senate President, Mr. Speaker, Members of Congress:

In the light of what has been accomplished since I last had the honor to address you, it is with an uplifted spirit that today I call for further determined and courageous action toward the great national goals.

During the year 1959 we touched a few peaks in progress' highway. We piled up bigger surpluses in rice and corn, thus firming up our success in the campaign for self-sufficiency in food. We have achieved favorable balance of trade for the first time in postwar years which is a definitive index of our economic growth. The nation was thrilled by the discovery of oil in Cebu which, together with steel, will give revolutionary impetus to our agro-industrial economy. Oil will soon be a mighty pillar of our economy. We launched the first ship built by Filipino naval architects and engineers which established once and for all our capacity in this field. This is significant and inspiring when we consider that we are a country of 7,000 islands. We have successfully conducted a peaceful, free and honest election in which the Filipino people reiterated confidence in the present Nacionalista administration. It was an untrammelled expression of the popular will and the overall result was the strengthening of the fabric of Philippine democracy. We have just laid the cornerstone of a Nuclear Center made possible by the United States granting us an Atomic Reactor. We have thus been ushered into the threshold of a spectacular industrial revolution with the use of atomic energy.

All of these achievements in the past year, to mention only the most outstanding, are at the same time pledges at a bigger tomorrow.

THE "FILIPINO FIRST" POLICY

The "Filipino First" policy of this administration received a resounding popular indorsement in the last election. Politically we became independent since 1946, but economically we are still semi-colonial. This is especially true in our foreign trade. This policy is therefore designed to regain economic independence. It is a national effort to the end that Filipinos obtain major and dominant participation in their own national economy. This we will achieve with malice towards none and with fairness to all. We will accomplish this with full understanding of our international obligations towards our friends of the Free World. We will carry this out within the framework of our special relations with the United States to whose citizens we granted until 1974, by Constitutional provision, equal rights as Filipinos in the exploitation of our natural resources and public utilities, and to whom we also granted trading parity rights under the Laurel-Langley Agreement. Under this policy we will welcome friendly and understanding foreign capital willing to collaborate with us in the exploitation of our vast natural resources preferably on joint venture basis.

It is my hope that legislations under this orientation will be enacted this year.

ECONOMIC PROGRESS

In vital matters related to the national economy, at the start of last year, we were facing serious difficulties. The international reserve stood at a dangerously low level and the financial position of the government was weak. So when I came before Congress to speak on the state of the nation, I proposed bold and decisive moves to stabilize the economy.

Congress in a historic special session patriotically responded by exacting a stabilization program the principal feature of which is the imposition of a margin fee on the sale of foreign exchange. In the middle of July a 25 per cent margin was put into effect.

It speaks highly of the courageous statesmanship of this Congress that in spite of a stormy opposition accompanied by gloomy predictions of the prophets of doom, it passed the measure even in an election year.

Now after barely five months of implementation thereof we find that we were able not only to halt the country's deteriorating balance of payments, but also to reverse it for the first time in postwar years from minus to plus. The 25 per cent margin on foreign exchange sales combined with the other disinflationary fiscal and credit restraint measures such as new tax laws, the cutback in bond financing, and such monetary instruments as the raising of reserve requirements, the raising of rediscount rates, selective rediscounting, the imposition of portfolio ceilings, and the continued effectivity of Central Bank Circular No. 79, have produced general salutary effects upon our national economy. Among these are: (1) the strengthening of the peso, (2) the strengthening of our international reserve to the tune of \$162.9 million, (3) the consolidation of the government's financial position, (4) the cutting down of excessive money supply, (5) the keeping down of excess bank reserves and credit, and (6), worthy of repeated mention, the attainment for the first time in postwar history of a favorable balance of trade and balance of payments to the tune of \$46.4 million. Moreover, we paid in 1959, \$84 million of our foreign loans and obligations.

Rural Development

Greater efforts should be made to diffuse the benefits and balance the economic development among the rural regions of the country. During the past year, I consistently advocated the dispersal of industries to the provinces to halt the dangerous tendency of overcrowded population in cities and to stop inflation of monetary circulation in Manila and suburbs while there was scarcity of money in the provinces.

The success of our program of self-sufficiency may be gauged by the increasing surpluses of rice and corn. Such surpluses have not only introduced price and marketing problems but also necessitate the reorientation of our production policies along the following lines: (1) redirection of our research activities towards high-yielding varieties suitable to the needs of foreign markets; (2) further studies in the development of new industrial uses of agricultural surpluses and raw materials; (3) improvement in our management practices so as to increase the production per hectare and thereby reduce the cost per unit of output; and (4) attunement of production to market demands so as to avoid undisposable surpluses and achieve steady and fair income for farmers. For instance, some Virginia tobacco lands in the Ilocos provinces, in the face of a

soaring tobacco surplus, may be shifted to cotton production needed by our expanding textile mills.

EDUCATION AND SCIENCE

We have continued to extend the benefits of education to an increasing number of children. Last year we were able to admit 119,000 new pupils by opening 3,000 additional classes.

However, because of budgetary limitations, the Government has had to fall back upon private institutions to supplement its educational efforts. To maintain the highest standards possible in these schools, an increase in the supervisory force would be desirable.

The teaching of science and mathematics as well as the improvement of the vocational curricula received greater impetus during the year. Radio broadcasts through a donation of 500 transistor radios from the Australian Government were started this year. The production of foodstuffs, as well as the promotion of home industries, has been pushed with greater vigor.

The creation of the National Science Development Board has given fresh impetus to the promotion of science and technology. Its research activities are geared to economic development and national health. For the first time all the research projects for the control of the dreaded kadang-kadang of coconuts have been consolidated in a Research Committee under the Board.

National Defense

Aside from pursuing its primary mission, the Department of National Defense has supplemented the rural development program of the Administration. In this connection, I wish to inform you that plans for the implementation of the Armed Forces commission under the law to engage in public construction, food production, land resettlement, and rural development in addition to its inherent duties have been completed. In fact, several projects are already being actually undertaken.

Our Armed Forces, I am proud to say, has done well in the maintenance of peace and order and the enforcement try's defense structure. We have every reason to be proud of the laws. It was the principal arm of the Commission on Elections that conducted in 1959 free, peaceful, and honest national elections. Its civilian chiefs and its general staff have accomplished much in the way of improving the count of its officers and men. They will continue to be an invaluable asset to the life of the nation.

Public Works

Under the retrenchment policy, the Government has confined itself to the construction and improvement of only essential public improvements which are supportive and promotive of agro-industrial development. Nevertheless, during the calendar year 1959 the Government undertook the construction of irrigation and water supply systems, flood control and shore protection works, airfields and airports, ports and harbors, and roads and bridges for which we invested One Hundred Sixty-Nine million pesos (P169 million). Worthy of note is the completion of national and communal irrigation systems and the installation of irrigation pumps, all of which can now irrigate about 45,000 additional hectares of agricultural land. The year 1959 also saw the virtual completion of the construction of 768 kilometers of development highways in Mindanao.

I invite the attention of Congress to the emerging need of legislation directed towards the multi-phase utilization and exploitation of the abundant water resources of the country not only for

power, but also for water supply, flood control and irrigation. In this way we can maximize the benefits for lowest cost.

In the case of other public works financed with dollar loans being extended both by the U.S. Export-Import Bank and the Development Loan Fund for transportation projects—air, land, and water—committed under the Eisenhower-Garcia communique on the occasion of my last state visit to the United States, legislative measures are necessary to make available sufficient peso support for projects already submitted to, or approved by, these lending institutions.

Health

The health of the nation has been maintained at a satisfactory level. The birth rate has shown a considerable increase whereas the death rate has decreased. Mortality rates from the ten leading causes of death have been reduced. All of these facts indicate an improvement in the cleanliness and sanitation of our communities.

The policy of improving the rural health centers is being pursued without letup. To supplement the services which have been made available to the rural areas, the help of private persons and firms has been enlisted. Efforts are being exerted to expand hospital services in the rural areas.

Ramon Magsaysay, Rizal Day Speech, June 19, 1956

Recognizing the important role of Jose Rizal in the attainment of our country's freedom, President Ramon Magsaysay signed the Republic Act 1425 also known as the Rizal Law on June 12, 1956. Sponsored by Senator Claro M. Recto, the law requires "to include in the curricula of all public and private schools, colleges and universities courses on the life, works and writings of Jose Rizal, particularly his novels *Noli Me Tangere* and *El Filibusterismo*..." The enactment of the said law was Recto's response to the postwar social crisis of neocolonialism and colonial mentality. The reading of Rizal's novels according to him "would strengthen the Filipinism of the youth and foster patriotism."

In his speech on Rizal Day of 1956, a few days after he signed the Rizal Law, Magsaysay emphasized the need to remember Rizal on his birthday and the importance of "living for our country." He highlighted the idea of "positive nationalism" that Rizal showed by understanding the social problem and presenting solutions to these challenges.

Rizal Day Speech of His Excellency Ramon Magsaysay President of the Philippines Before the Lions Clubs

[Delivered at the Manila Hotel, June 19, 1956]

LION CHAIRMAN MARIANING DEL ROSARIO,
DISTINGUISHED MEMBERS OF THE MANILA BAY AREA LIONS CLUBS,
MY FRIENDS:

PERMIT me to thank the officers and members of the Bay Area Lions Clubs for this privilege of addressing you on this day. You are to be commended for stressing with this celebration the significance of the anniversary of the birthday of Jose Rizal.

Indeed, it is time perhaps that our people should give to the day of his birth the same attention and importance that we give to the day of his death, for there are many things about Rizal that we can learn by reflection on his life which we might miss in reflecting on the tragedy and the glory of his death.

The recent generations of our people have had many occasions in which to die for our country. When those times have come, it has been the heroism of Rizal in the face of death that inspired them in battle or in the face of the executioner.

Today, however, you will perhaps agree with me that we are mainly concerned with living for our country. We are concerned with giving life, a decent life, to the millions of our people. We

are concerned with giving life and strength to our national freedom and individual liberties. We are concerned with giving life to our Constitution and to the laws that our own free representatives have enacted for our welfare.

In implementing this concern the question that we ask about Rizal is not so much “how did he die?” as “how did he live?” And this day is a good day in which to seek the answer.

How did Rizal live? Perhaps we should first ask—What did he live for? Rizal lived for his country. How did he live for his country? He lived for it first by understanding the problems of the Philippines of his day. He faced the realities which the forces of his country had created around him. He singled out the enemies of his country’s freedom. And then he chose the most effective weapons with which to conquer them. He learned how to wield these weapons. And finally he used them effectively and decisively to defeat the enemy and bring freedom to his people.

What do we not find in Rizal’s life? We do not find him fighting the battles of Lapu-Lapu with 16th century swords or haranguing his countrymen with the rough, rustic eloquence of Dagohoy. We find him fighting the enemies of his time with the weapons of his time, with the polished satire of the 19th century, seeking thereby not only to awaken the spirit of his own countrymen but also to stir up the sympathy of the most cultured centers of Europe towards the cause of his country’s freedom. Such was the realism of Rizal. Such was the constructive bent of his patriotism. Such was the positive spirit of his nationalism.

Indeed, in every period of a country’s history, it is true nationalism that gives its people that necessary energy with which to conquer the problems of their times. It is the realistic, constructive, and the positive nationalism of Rizal which, by facing present problems with present solutions, will propel us in the right direction towards the security, the prosperity, and the happiness of our people.

What are our problems today? They are to permit the enjoyment of the fruits of our freedom by as many of our countrymen as possible, to harness our resources and gather economic strength with which to support that freedom, and to prepare ourselves to defend that freedom against the forces that threaten to destroy it.

We can inspire ourselves to solve these problems by recalling the principles of our dead heroes. But we cannot actually solve them by using obsolete weapons, recalling old hatreds and resurrecting buried enemies. We can, like Rizal, learn from the past without reviving the problems of the past and without shadow boxing with the spirit of the vanquished foe.

It would be wrong, for instance to approach our coming relations with Japan by recalling our hatred of the Japanese militarist even though it was barely ten years ago that we suffered under his yoke. Let us recall that Rizal himself had a high respect for the intrinsic humaneness of the Japanese people.

As with the ten year old hatreds, so must we deal with the older ones. Let us nourish in our hearts a love for our country that looks forward. Let us nurture a love that builds and will not destroy the very things that support our freedom. Rizal said “the glory of saving a country is not for him who has contributed to its ruin Hate never produces anything but monsters; and crime,

nothing but criminals Love alone realizes successful works; virtue alone can save Redemption presupposes virtue; sacrifice, love”

My friends, countless problems challenge our solution. They can be solved if we get together inspired with love for our country and for our countrymen and if we approach them with goodwill and without rancor or abuse.

A country can achieve lasting greatness only if that greatness is built on the sound constructive bases of virtue, sacrifice, and love. For countries, like persons, must also be judged by the moral code. Rizal said “If to make my country happy I should have to do evil, I would refuse to do it, because I am sure that what is built on sand must sooner or later fall to the ground.”

If we must build for the future, we must solve the present with the solutions of our time. If we must strengthen our freedom we must use the resources at hand. If we must defend that freedom, we must know who is its real enemy today and prepare to foil him with the weapons of today. If we want to help our country, we must be prepared to sacrifice ourselves. But to sacrifice ourselves we must be possessed of love—love for our God, our country, and our people.

If our devotion to Rizal is sincere and genuine, then we must remember, each and every one of us, that we owe it to ourselves and to our country to seek constantly to discipline ourselves and dedicate our efforts to our country. As Rafael Palma has said, we have a right to believe that there is in each one of us a possible Rizal; and that what he has done, we too could do within our reach and capabilities, if we would only apply to our tasks the same determination, the same resolute action, the same sense of duty that Rizal applied to the most heroic acts of his life.

Let, then, this commemoration of Rizal’s 95th birthday inspire in each of us a firm determination to dedicate ourselves anew with a chastened spirit and renewed vigor to this our beloved country which Rizal, blessing her with his blood, has bequeathed to us, for us to love, to dignify, and to serve.

Inaugural Address of President Magsaysay, December 30, 1953.

Source:<https://www.officialgazette.gov.ph/1953/12/30/inaugural-address-of-president-magsaysay-december-30-1953/>

This excerpt below shows President Magsaysay's inaugural address. During his campaign, Magsaysay's image to the electorate was focused on his roots as a candidate of the common man, and his accomplishment to put an end to the Huk rebellion. The address below resonated this image by committing to establish a government that treats everyone fairly and justly, both the rich and the poor. President Magsaysay made special mention to address the interest of the common people, particularly those in barrios and neglected rural areas as well as laborers and industrial workers through social justice programs. One of such promises in his inaugural was a reexamination of the land reform program. On the other hand, Magsaysay announced his commitment to the Mutual Defense Treaty with the United States as a way to uphold the international responsibilities of the Philippines, and the aid from this international economic cooperation with the United States shall be extended to the rural areas to aid the common people.

EXCERPT:

**INAUGURAL ADDRESS
OF
HIS EXCELLENCY RAMON MAGSAYSAY
PRESIDENT OF THE PHILIPPINES
[Delivered at the Independence Grandstand, Manila, on December 30, 1953]**

My Countrymen:

You have called upon me to assume the highest office within our gift. I accept the trust humbly and gratefully. My sole determination is to be President for the people.

The office of President is the highest in the land. It can be the humblest also, if we regard it – as we must – in the light of basic democratic principles. The first of these principles is the declaration of the Constitution that “sovereignty resides in the people and all government authority emanates from them.” This simply means that all of us in public office are but servants of the people.

As I see it, your mandate in the past election was not a license for the selfish enjoyment of power by any man or group of men. On the contrary, it was an endorsement of the principle – at times forgotten – that the general welfare is the only justification for the exercise of governmental power and authority.

Your mandate was a clear and urgent command to establish for our people a government based upon honesty and morality; a government sensitive to your needs, dedicated to your best interests, and inspired by our highest ideals of man's liberty.

We have a glorious past. Now we must build a future worthy of that past.

It is significant that we begin on this day and on this ground hallowed by the supreme sacrifice of Jose Rizal. We can find no finer example of dedication to country to light our way.

All too often, however, we speak of Rizal – and of Del Pilar, Bonifacio, Mabini, and our host of heroes – as if their work were done, as if today their spirit had ceased to have any meaning or value to our people. The truth is that we need their spirit now more than ever. We need it to complete the work which they began.

We need men of integrity and faith like Rizal and Del Pilar; men of action like Bonifacio; men of inflexible patriotism like Mabini. We need their zeal, their self-reliance, their capacity for work, their devotion to service, their ability to lose themselves in the common cause of building a nation.

I will have such men. From this day, the members of my administration, beginning with myself, shall cease to belong to our parties, to our families, even to ourselves. We shall belong only to the people.

In the administration of public affairs, all men entrusted with authority must adhere firmly to the ideals and principles of the Constitution.

I will render – and demand – uncompromising loyalty to the basic tenet of our Constitution; that you, the people, are sovereign. The rule of government must be service to you.

Accordingly, I pledge my administration to your service. I pledge that we shall extend the protection of the law to everyone, fairly and impartially – to the rich and the poor, the learned and the unlettered – recognizing no party but the nation, no family but the great family of our race, no interest save the common welfare.

The Bill of Rights shall be for me and the members of my administration, a bill of duties. We shall be guardians of the freedom and dignity of the individual.

More than this, we shall strive to give meaning and substance to the liberties guaranteed by our Constitution – by helping our citizens to attain the economic well-being so essential to the enjoyment of civil and political rights.

The separation of powers ordained by our Constitution – as an effective safeguard against tyranny – shall be preserved zealously. Mutual respect for the rights and prerogative of each of the three great departments of government must be observed.

The legislative power vested by the Constitution, in the elected representatives of the people will, I trust, operate vigorously to prosecute our common program of honest, efficient and constructive government. As Executive, I look forward to intimate cooperation with the members of Congress, particularly with those statesmen who have stood guard over the rights and liberties of our people.

The independence of the judiciary shall be strengthened. Our courts must be freed from political and other baneful influences, so that they may function with the same integrity and impartiality which have made our Supreme Court the fortress of law and justice.

Heretofore, social justice has raised fervent but frustrated hopes in the hearts of our less fortunate citizens. We must not permit social justice to be an empty phrase in our Constitution. We must bring it to life – for all.

In consonance with this purpose, my administration shall take positive, energetic measures to improve the living conditions of our fellow citizens in the barrios and neglected rural areas and of laborers in our urban and industrial centers.

The land tenure system of our country shall be reexamined, to purge it of injustice and oppression.

“Land for the landless” shall be more than just a catch-phrase. We will translate it into actuality. We will clear and open for settlement our vast and fertile public lands which, under the coaxing of willing hearts and industrious hands, are waiting to yield substance to millions of our countrymen.

Democracy becomes meaningless if it fails to satisfy the primary needs of the common man, if it cannot give him freedom from fear and on which a strong republic can be built. His happiness and security are the only foundations on which a strong republic can be built. His happiness and security shall be foremost among the goals of my administration.

We must develop the national economy so that it may better satisfy the material needs of our people. The benefits of any economic or industrial development program shall be channeled first to our common people, so that their living standards shall be raised.

While I shall give priority to our domestic problems, my administration will not neglect our international responsibilities. We cannot escape the fact that, today, the destinies of nations are closely linked. It is in this spirit that we regard the goodwill and assistance extended to us through the various programs of international economic cooperation with the more developed

nations, chiefly the United States. Considering this aid to be primarily a means of speeding up our progress toward self-reliance, I pledge that every peso worth of assistance will be spent honestly and to the best advantage.

It is to our common interest that this Republic, a monument to mutual goodwill and common labor, should prove to the world the vitality of the democracy by which we live.

We shall continue to cooperate with the United Nations in seeking collective security and a just world peace.

No effort will be spared, no element of cooperation will be withheld in strengthening and safeguarding our physical security. We are prepared to live up to all our obligations under our Mutual Defense Treaty with the United States.

To our Asian brothers, we send our fraternal greetings. They are beset by problems of the same nature and complexity as those that confront us. We invite them to share our experience in finding solutions to those problems through democratic means. It is my hope that we can exchange experiences and information on methods that each of us has found most effective in subduing illiteracy, poverty, disease, under-productivity, and other common evils which have afflicted our countries of past generations.

The problems and opportunities ahead of us set the measure of the effort we must exert in the years to come. We must have unity to solve our problems, cooperation to exploit our opportunities. I urge you to forego partisan differences whenever the national interest clearly demands united action. We must not be distracted from our work. We have no time for petty strife.

Certainly we cannot temporize with armed dissidence. I therefore call upon the remnants of the Huk uprising still hiding in the hills to lay down their arms – and rejoin the rest of the nation in the ways of peace. I say to the rank and file of the Huks – who have been misled by the lies of the Kremlin – that they can win the economic security and social justice they desire only within the framework of our democracy. We shall welcome back the truly repentant with understanding and with sympathy.

But, to the leaders of the Communist conspiracy who would deliver this country and its people to a foreign power, this I say: I shall use all the forces at my command to the end that the sovereign authority of this government shall be respected and maintained. There can be no compromise with disloyalty.

I have been warned that too much is expected of this administration, that our people expect the impossible. For this young and vigorous nation of ours, nothing is really impossible!

Let us have faith in ourselves, the same faith that fired the heroic generation of revolution. They waged and won their struggle with nothing but bolos in their hands and courage in their hearts. Without political training and experience, they wrote a constitution comparable with the best, and established the first republic in Asia. Our own generation was told by doubters and enemies that we would never have independence from the United States. We live today under a free and sovereign Republic. Our faith was fulfilled.

Today, we are told anew that it is impossible to do what must be done. But our people, sustained by God, under whose protection we have placed our destiny and happiness, and strengthened by an abiding faith in His goodness and mercy – our people, united and free, shall shape a future worthy of our noble heritage if we but act; act together; act wisely; act with courage; and act unselfishly, in a spirit of patriotic dedication.

"1947 RP-US Military Bases Agreement" Accessed November 21, 2020.

Source: <https://www.loc.gov/law/help/us-treaties/bevans/b-ph-ust000011-0055.pdf>.

The agreement between the Philippines and the United States concerning military bases also known as the Military Bases Agreement was signed on March 14, 1947 by Manuel Roxas on behalf of the Philippine Government and by Ambassador Paul V. McNutt on behalf of the President of the United States. This agreement gave the US a 99-year lease on a number of military and naval bases in the Philippines. The two major facilities included Clark Air Base in Pampanga and the Subic Naval Base which included the whole city of Olongapo within its jurisdiction. This agreement placed no restrictions to which the US could put the bases nor the types of weapons it could store there. It also allowed US to recruit Filipino volunteers into the US Armed Forces.

Over the years, some of the provisions of the said agreement have been revised. Among the important changes included the returning of base lands to the Philippine government including the city of Olongapo. In 1966, the term of agreement was changed to expire in 1991.

EXCERPT:

AGREEMENT BETWEEN THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA AND THE REPUBLIC

OF THE PHILIPPINES CONCERNING MILITARY BASES

WHEREAS, the war in the Pacific has confirmed the mutuality of interest of the United States of America and of the Republic of the Philippines in matters relating to the defense of their respective territories and that mutuality of interest demands that the Governments of the two countries take the necessary measures to promote their mutual security and to defend their territories and areas;

WHEREAS, the governments of the United States of America and of the Republic of the Philippines are desirous of cooperating in the common defense of their two countries through arrangements consonant with the procedures and objectives of the United Nations, and particularly through a grant to the United States of America by the Republic of the Philippines in the exercise of its title and sovereignty, of the use, free of rent, in furtherance of the mutual interest of both countries, of certain lands of the public domain;

WHEREAS, the Government of the Republic of the Philippines has requested United States assistance in providing for the defense of the Philippines and in developing for such defense effective Philippine armed forces;

WHEREAS, pursuant to this request the Government of the United States of America has, in view of its interest in the welfare of the Philippines, indicated its intention of dispatching a military mission to the Philippines and of extending to her appropriate assistance in the development of the Philippine defense forces;

WHEREAS, a Joint Resolution of the Congress of the United States of America of June 29, 1944,“ authorized the President of the United States of America to acquire bases for the mutual protection of the United States of America and of the Philippines; and

WHEREAS, Joint Resolution No. 4 of the Congress of the Philippines, approved July 28, 1945,“ authorized the President of the United States of America to negotiate with the President of the Philippines for the establishment of bases provided for in the Joint Resolution of the Congress of the United States of America of June 29, 1944, with a view to insuring the territorial integrity of the Philippines, the mutual protection of the United States of America and the Philippines, and the maintenance of peace in the Pacific;

THEREFORE, the governments of the Republic of the Philippines and of the United States of America agree upon the following terms for the delimitation, establishment, maintenance and operation of military bases in the Philippines:

ARTICLE 1

GRANTS OF BASES

1. The Government of the Republic of the Philippines (hereinafter referred to as the Philippines) grants to the Government of the United States of America (hereinafter referred to as the United States) the right to retain the use of the bases in the Philippines listed in Annex A attached hereto.

2. Philippines agrees to permit the United States, upon notice to the Philippines, to use such of those bases listed in Annex B as the United States determines to be required by military necessity.

3. The Philippines agrees to enter into negotiations with the United States at the latter's request, to permit the United States to expand such bases, to exchange such bases for other bases, to acquire additional bases, or relinquish rights to bases, as any of such exigencies may be required by military necessity.

4. A narrative description of the boundaries of the bases to which this Agreement relates is given in Annex A and Annex B. An exact description of the bases listed in Annex A, with metes and bounds, in conformity with the narrative descriptions, will be agreed upon between the appropriate authorities of the two Governments as soon as possible. With respect to any of the bases listed in Annex B, an exact description with metes and bounds, in conformity with the narrative description of such bases, will be agreed upon if and when such bases are acquired by the United States.

ARTICLE II

MUTUAL COOPERATION

1. It is mutually agreed that the armed forces of the Philippines may serve on United States bases and that the armed forces of the United States may serve on Philippine military establishments whenever such conditions appear beneficial as mutually determined by the armed forces of both countries.

2. Joint outlined plans for the development of military bases in the Philippines may be prepared by military authorities of the two Governments.

3. In the interest of international security any bases listed in Annexes A and B may be made available to the Security Council of the United Nations on its call by prior mutual agreement between the United States and the Philippines.

ARTICLE III

DESCRIPTION OF RIGHTS

1. It is mutually agreed that the United States shall have the rights, power and authority within the bases which are necessary for the establishment, use, operation and defense thereof or appropriate for the control thereof and all the rights, power and authority within the limits of territorial waters and air space adjacent to, or in the vicinity of, the bases which are necessary to provide access to them, or appropriate for their control.

2. Such rights, power and authority shall include, *inter alia*, the right, power and authority:

(a) to construct (including dredging and filling) , operate, maintain, utilize, occupy, garrison and control the bases;

(b) to improve and deepen the harbors, channels, entrances and anchorages, and to construct or maintain necessary roads and bridges affording access to the bases;

(c) to control (including the right to prohibit) in so far as may be required for the efficient operation and safety of the bases, and within the limits of military necessity, anchorages, moorings, landings, takeoffs, movements and operation of ships and waterborne craft, aircraft and other vehicles on water, in the air or on land comprising or in the vicinity of the bases;

(d) the right to acquire, as may be agreed between the two Governments, such rights of way, and to construct thereon, as may be required for military purposes, wire and radio communications facilities, including submarine and subterranean cables, pipe lines and spur tracks from railroads to bases, and the right, as may be agreed upon between the two Governments to construct the necessary facilities;

(i.e. to construct, install, maintain, and employ on any base any type of

facilities, weapons, substance, device, vessel or vehicle on or under the ground, in the air or on or under the water that may be requisite or appropriate, including meteorological systems, aerial and water navigation lights, radio and radar apparatus and electronic devices, of any desired power, type of emission and frequency.

3. In the exercise of the above-mentioned rights, power and authority, the United States agrees that the powers granted to it will not be used unreasonably or, unless required by military necessity determined by the two governments, so as to interfere with the necessary rights of navigation, aviation, communication, or land travel within the territories of the Philippines. In the practical application outside the bases of the rights, power and authority granted in this Article there shall be, as the occasion requires, consultation between the two Governments.

ARTICLE IV

SHIPPING AND NAVIGATION

1. It is mutually agreed that United States public vessels operated by or for the War or Navy Departments, the Coast Guard or the Coast and Geodetic Survey, and the military forces of the United States, military and naval aircraft and Government-owned vehicles, including **armor**, shall be accorded free access to and movement between ports and United States bases throughout the Philippines, including territorial waters, by land, air and sea. This right shall include freedom from compulsory pilotage and all toll charges. If, however, a pilot is taken, pilotage shall be paid for at appropriate rates. In connection with entrance into Philippine ports by United States public vessels appropriate notification under normal conditions shall be made to the Philippine authorities.

2. Lights and other aids to navigation of vessels and aircraft placed or established in the bases and territorial waters adjacent thereto or in the vicinity of such bases shall conform to the system in use in the Philippines. The position, characteristics and any alterations in the lights or other aids shall be communicated in advance to the appropriate authorities of the Philippines.

3. Philippine commercial vessels may use the bases on the same terms and conditions as United States commercial vessels.

4. It is understood that a base is not a part of the territory of the United States for the purpose of coastwise shipping laws so as to exclude Philippine vessels from trade between the United States and the bases.

ARTICLE V

EXEMPTION FROM CUSTOMS AND OTHER DUTIES

No import, excise, consumption or other tax, duty or import shall be charged on material, equipment, supplies or goods, including food stores and clothing, for exclusive use in the construction, maintenance, operation or defense of the bases, consigned to, or destined for, the United States authorities and certified by them to be for such purposes.

ARTICLE VI

MANEUVER AND OTHER AREAS

The United States shall, subject to previous agreement with the Philip- pines, have the right to use land and coastal sea areas of appropriate size and location for periodic maneuvers, for additional staging areas, bombing and Nunnery ranges, and for such intermediate airfields as may be required for safe and efficient air operations. Operations in such areas shall be carried on with due regard and safeguards for the public safety.

ARTICLE VII

USE OF PUBLIC SERVICES

It is mutually agreed that the United States may employ and use for United States military forces any and all public utilities, other services and facilities, airfields, ports, harbors, roads, highways, railroads, bridges, via- ducts, canals, lakes, rivers and streams in the Philippines under conditions no less favorable than those that may be applicable from time to time to the military forces of the Philippines.

ARTICLE VIII

HEALTH MEASURES OUTSIDE BASES

It is mutually agreed that the United States may construct, subject to agreement by the appropriate Philippine authorities, wells, water catchment areas or dams to insure an ample supply of water for all base operations and personnel. The United States shall likewise have the right, in cooperation with the appropriate authorities of the Philippines, to take such steps as may be mutually agreed upon to be necessary to improve health and sanitation in areas contiguous to the bases, including the right, under such conditions as may be mutually agreed upon, to enter and inspect any privately owned property. The United States shall pay just compensation for any injury to persons or damage to property that may result from action taken in connection with this Article.

ARTICLE IX

SURVEYS

It is mutually agreed that the United States shall have the right, after appropriate notification has been given to the Philippines, to make topographic, hydrographic, and coast and geodetic surveys and aerial photo- graphs in any part of the Philippines and waters adjacent thereto. Copies with title and triangulation data of

any surveys or photomaps made of the Philippines shall be furnished to the Philippines.

ARTICLE X

CEMETERIES AND HISTORICAL SITES

1. The United States shall have the right to retain and maintain such United States military cemeteries and such sites of historical significance to the United States as may be agreed upon by the two Governments. All rights, power and authority in relation to bases granted under this Agreement shall be applicable, in so far as appropriate, to the cemeteries and sites mentioned in this Article.

2. Furthermore, it is recognized that there are certain cemeteries and historical sites in the Philippines revered in the memory of the People of the United States and of the Philippines, and it is therefore fitting that the maintenance and improvement of such memorials be the common concern of the two countries.

ARTICLE XI

IMMIGRATION

1. It is mutually agreed that the United States shall have the right to bring into the Philippines members of the United States military forces and the United States nationals employed by or under a contract with the United States together with their families, and technical personnel of other nationalities (not being persons excluded by the laws of the Philippines) in connection with the construction, maintenance, or operation of the bases. The United States shall make suitable arrangements so that such persons may be readily identified and their status established when necessary by the Philippine authorities. Such persons, other than members of the United States armed forces in uniform, shall present their travel documents to the appropriate Philippine authorities for visas, it being understood that no objection will be made to their travel to the Philippines as non-immigrants.

2. If the status of any person within the Philippines and admitted thereto under the foregoing paragraph shall be altered so that he would no longer be entitled to such admission, the United States shall notify the Philippines and shall, 'I such person be required to leave the Philippines by the latter government, be responsible for providing him with a passage from the Philippines within a

reasonable time, and shall in the meantime prevent his becoming a public responsibility of the Philippines.

ARTICLE XII

INTERNAL REVENUE TAX EXEMPTION

1. No member of the United States armed forces, except Filipino citizens, serving in the Philippines in connection with the bases and residing in the Philippines by reason only of such service, or his dependents, shall be liable to pay income tax in the Philippines except in respect of income derived from Philippine sources.

2. No national of the United States serving in or employed in the Philippines in connection with the construction, maintenance, operation, or defense of the bases and residing in the Philippines by reason only of such employment, or his spouse and minor children and dependent parents or either spouse, shall be liable to pay income tax in the Philippines except in respect of income derived from Philippine sources or sources other than the United States sources.

3. No person referred to in paragraphs 1 and 2 of this Article shall be liable to pay to the Government or local authorities of the Philippines any poll or residence tax, or any import or export duty, or any other tax on personal property imported for his own use; provided that privately owned vehicles shall be subject to payment of the following only: when certified as being used for military purposes by appropriate United States authorities, the normal license plate fee; otherwise, the normal license plate and registration fees.

4. No national of the United States, or corporation organized under the laws of the United States, resident in the United States, shall be liable to pay income tax in the Philippines in respect of any profits derived under a contract made in the United States with the Government of the United States in connection with the construction, maintenance, operation and defense of the bases, or any tax in the nature of a license in respect of any service or work for the United States in connection with the construction, maintenance, operation and defense of the bases

ARTICLE XIII “

JURISDICTION

1. The Philippines consents that the United States shall have the right to exercise jurisdiction over the following offenses:

- (a) Any offense committed by any person within any base except where the offender and offended parties are both Philippine citizens (not members of the armed forces of the United States on active duty) or the offense is against the security of the Philippines;
- (b) Any offense committed outside the bases by any member of the armed forces of the United States in which the offended party is also a member of the armed forces of the United States; and
- (c) Any offense committed outside the bases by any member of the armed forces of the United States against the security of the United States.

2. The Philippines shall have the right to exercise jurisdiction over all other offenses committed outside the bases by any member of the armed forces of the United States.

3. Whenever for special reasons the United States may desire not to exercise the jurisdiction reserved to it in paragraphs 1 and 6 of this Article, the officer holding the offender in custody shall so notify the fiscal (prosecuting attorney) of the city or province in which the offense has been committed within ten days after his arrest, and in such a case the Philippines shall exercise jurisdiction.

4. Whenever for special reasons the Philippines may desire not to exercise the jurisdiction reserved to it in paragraph 2 of this Article, the fiscal (prosecuting attorney) of the city or province where the offense has been committed shall so notify the officer holding the offender in custody within ten days after his arrest, and in such a case the United States shall be free to exercise jurisdiction. If any offense falling under paragraph 2 of this Article is committed by any member of the armed forces of the United States

(a) while engaged in the actual performance of a specific military duty,

or

(Ib) during a period of national emergency declared by either government and the fiscal (prosecuting attorney) so finds from the evidence, he shall immediately notify the officer holding the offender in custody that the United States is free to exercise jurisdiction. In the event the fiscal (prosecuting attorney) finds that the offense was not committed in the actual performance of a specific military duty, the offender's commanding officer shall have the right to appeal from such finding to the Secretary of Justice

within ten days from the receipt of the decision of the **fiscal** and the decision of the Secretary of Justice shall be final.

5. In all cases over which the Philippines exercises jurisdiction the custody of the accused, pending trial and final judgment, shall be entrusted without delay to the commanding officer of the nearest base, who shall acknowledge in writing that such accused has been delivered to him for custody pending trial in a competent court of the Philippines and that he will be held ready to appear and will be produced before said court when required by it. The commanding officer shall be furnished by the fiscal (prosecuting attorney) with a copy of the information against the accused upon the filing of the original in the competent court.

6. Notwithstanding the foregoing provisions, it is mutually agreed that in time of war the United States shall have the right to exercise exclusive jurisdiction over any offenses which may be committed by members of the armed forces of the United States in the Philippines.

7. The United States agrees that it will not grant asylum in any of the bases to any person fleeing from the lawful jurisdiction of the Philippines. Should any such person be found in any base, he will be surrendered on demand to the competent authorities of the Philippines.

8. In every case in which jurisdiction over an offense is exercised by the United States, the offended party may institute a separate civil action against the offender in the proper court of the Philippines to enforce the civil liability which under the laws of the Philippines may arise from the offense.

ARTICLE XIV

ARREST AND SERVICE OF PROCESS

1. No arrest shall be made and no process, civil or criminal, shall be served within any base except with the permission of the commanding officer of such base; but should the commanding officer refuse to grant such permission he shall (except in cases of arrest where the United States has jurisdiction under Article **XIII**) forthwith take the necessary steps to arrest the person charged and surrender him to the appropriate authorities of the Philippines or to serve such process, as the case may be, and to provide the attendance of the server of such process before the

appropriate court in the Philippines or procure such server to make the necessary affidavit or declaration to prove such service as the case may require.

2. In cases where the service courts of the United States have jurisdiction under Article **XIII**, the appropriate authorities of the Philippines will, on request, give reciprocal facilities as regards the service of process and the arrest and surrender of alleged offenders.

ARTICLE XV

SECURITY LEGISLATION

The Philippines agrees to take such steps as may from time to time be agreed to be necessary with a view to the enactment of legislation to insure the adequate security and protection of the United States bases, equipment and other property and the operations of the United States under this Agreement, and the punishment of persons who may contravene such legislation. It is mutually agreed that appropriate authorities of the two t3overnments will also consult from time to time in order to insure that laws and regulations of the United States and of the Philippines in relation to such matters shall, so far as may be possible, be uniform in character.

ARTICLE XVI

POSTAL FACILITIES

It is mutually agreed that the United States shall have the right to establish and maintain United States post offices in the bases for the exclusive use of the United States armed forces, and civilian personnel who are nationals of the United States and employed in connection with the construction, maintenance, and operation of the bases, and the families of such persons, for domestic use between United States post offices in the bases and between such post offices and other United States post offices. The United States shall have the right to regulate and control within the bases all communications within, to and from such bases.

ARTICLE XVII

REMOVAL OF IMPROVEMENTS

1. It is mutually agreed that the United States shall have the right to remove or dispose of any or all removable improvements, equipment or facilities located at or on any base and paid for with funds of the United States. No export tax shall be charged on any material or equipment so removed from the Philippines.

2. All buildings and structures which are erected by the United States in the bases shall be the property of the United States and may be removed by it before the expiration of this Agreement or the earlier relinquishment of the base on which the structures are situated. There shall be no obligation on the part of the United States or of the Philippines to rebuild or repair any destruction or damage inflicted from any cause whatsoever on any of the said buildings or structures owned or used by the United States in the bases. The United States is not obligated to turn over the bases to the Philippines at the expiration of this Agreement or the earlier relinquishment of any bases in the condition in which they were at the time of their occupation, nor is the Philippines obliged to make any compensation to the United States for the improvements made in the bases or for the buildings or structures left thereon; all of which shall become the property of the Philippines upon the termination of the Agreement or the earlier relinquishment by the United States of the bases where the structures have been built.

ARTICLE XVIII

SALES AND SERVICES WITHIN THE BASES

1. It is mutually agreed that the United States shall have the right to establish on bases, free of all licenses; fees; sales, excise or other taxes, or imposts; Government agencies, including concessions, such as sales commissaries and post exchanges, messes and social clubs, for the exclusive use of the United States military forces and authorized civilian personnel and their families. The merchandise or services sold or dispensed by such agencies shall be free of all taxes, duties and inspection by the Philippine authorities. Administrative measures shall be taken by the appropriate authorities of the United States to prevent the resale of goods which are sold under the provisions of this Article to persons not entitled to buy goods at such agencies and, generally, to prevent abuse of the privileges granted under this Article. There shall be cooperation between such authorities and the Philippines to this end.

2. Except as may be provided in any other agreements, no person shall habitually render any professional services in a base except to or for the United States or to or for the persons mentioned in the preceding paragraph. No business shall be established in a base, it being understood that the Government agencies mentioned

in the preceding paragraph shall not be regarded as businesses for the purposes of this Article.

ARTICLE XIX

COMMERCIAL CONCERNS

It is mutually agreed that the United States shall have the right, with the consent of the Philippines, to grant to commercial concerns owned or controlled by the citizens of the United States or of the Philippines such rights to the use of any base or facility retained or acquired by the United States as may be deemed appropriate by both Governments to insure the development and maintenance for defense purposes of such bases and facilities.

ARTICLE XX

MILITARY OR NAVAL POLICE

It is mutually agreed that there shall be close cooperation on a reciprocal basis between the military and naval police forces of the United States and the police forces of the Philippines for the purpose of preserving order and discipline among United States military and naval personnel

ARTICLE XXI

TEMPORARY INSTALLATIONS

1. It is mutually agreed that the United States shall retain the right to occupy temporary quarters and installations now existing outside the bases mentioned in Annex A and Annex B, for such reasonable time, not exceeding two years," as may be necessary to develop adequate facilities within the bases for the United States armed forces. If circumstances require an extension of time, such a period will be fixed by mutual agreement of the two Governments; but such extension shall not apply to the existing temporary quarters and installations within the limits of the City of Manila and shall in no case exceed a period of three years.
2. Notwithstanding the provisions of the preceding paragraph, the Port of Manila reservation with boundaries as of 1941 will be available for use to the United States armed forces until such time as other arrangements can be made for supply of the bases by mutual agreement of the two Governments.

3. The terms of this Agreement pertaining to bases shall be applicable to temporary quarters and installations referred to in paragraph 1 of this Article while they are so occupied by the armed forces of the United States; provided, that offenses committed within the temporary quarters and installations located within the present limits of the City of Manila shall not be considered as offenses within the bases but shall be governed by the Provisions of Article XIII, paragraphs 2 and 4, except that the election not to exercise the jurisdiction reserved to the Philippines shall be made by the Secretary of Justice. It is agreed that the United States shall have full use and full control of all these quarters and installations while they are occupied by the armed forces of the United States, including the exercise of such measures as may be necessary to police said quarters for the security of the personnel and property therein.

ARTICLE XII

CONDEMNATION OR EXPROPRIATION

1. Whenever it is necessary to acquire by condemnation or expropriation proceedings real property belonging to any private persons, associations or corporations located in bases named in Annex A and Annex B in order to carry out the purposes of this Agreement, the Philippines will institute and prosecute such condemnation or expropriation proceedings in accordance with the laws of the Philippines. The United States agrees to reimburse the Philippines for all the reasonable expenses, damages and costs thereby incurred, including the value of the property as determined by the Court. In addition, subject to the mutual agreement of the two Governments, the United States will reimburse the Philippines for the reasonable costs of transportation and removal of any occupants displaced or ejected by reason of the condemnation or expropriation.

2. Prior to the completion of such condemnation or expropriation proceedings, in cases of military necessity the United States shall have the right to take possession of such property required for military purposes as soon as the legal requisites for obtaining possession have been fulfilled.

3. The properties acquired under this Article shall be turned over to the Philippines upon the expiration of this Agreement, or the earlier relinquishment of such properties, under such terms and conditions as may be agreed upon by the two Governments.

ARTICLE XXIII

CIVIL LIABILITY

For the purpose of promoting and maintaining friendly relations by the prompt settlement of meritorious claims, the United States shall pay just and reasonable compensation, when accepted by claimants in full satisfaction and in final settlement, for claims, including claims of insured but excluding claims of subrogees, on account of damage to or loss or destruction of private property, both real and personal, or personal injury or death of inhabitants of the Philippines, when such damage, loss, destruction or injury is caused by the armed forces of the United States, or individual members thereof, including military or civilian employees thereof, or otherwise incident to non-combat activities of such forces; provided that no claim shall be considered unless presented within one year after the occurrence of the accident or incident out of which such claim arises.

ARTICLE XXIV

MINERAL RESOURCES

All minerals (including oil) , and antiquities and all rights relating thereto and to treasure trove, under, upon, or connected with the land and water comprised in the bases or otherwise used or occupied by the United States by virtue of this Agreement, are reserved to the Government and inhabitants of the Philippines; but no rights so reserved shall be transferred to third parties, or exercised within the bases, without the consent of the United States. The United States shall negotiate with the proper Philippine authorities for the quarrying of rock and gravel necessary for construction work on the bases.

ARTICLE XXV

GRANT OF BASES TO A THIRD POWER

1. The Philippines agrees that it shall not grant, without prior consent of the United States, any bases or any rights, power, or authority what-soever, in or relating to bases, to any third power.

2. It is further agreed that the United States shall not, without the consent of the Philippines, assign, or underlet, or part with the possession of the whole or any part of any base, or of any right, power or authority granted by this Agreement, to any third power.

ARTICLE XXVI

DEFINITION OF BASES

For the purposes of this Agreement, bases are those areas named in Annex A and Annex B and such additional areas as may be acquired for military purposes pursuant to the terms of this Agreement.

ARTICLE XXVII

VOLUNTARY ENLISTMENT OF PHILIPPINE CITIZENS

It is mutually agreed that the United States shall have the right to recruit citizens of the Philippines for voluntary enlistment into the United States armed forces for a fixed term of years, and to train them and to exercise the same degree of control and discipline over them as is exercised in the case of other members of the United States armed forces. The number of such enlistments to be accepted by the armed forces of the United States may from time to time be limited by agreement between the two Governments.

ARTICLE XXVIII

UNITED STATES RESERVE ORGANIZATIONS

It is mutually agreed that the United States shall have the right to enroll and train all eligible United States citizens residing in the Philippines in the Reserve organizations of the armed forces of the United States, which include the Officers Reserve Corps and the Enlisted Reserve Corps, except that prior consent of the Philippines shall be obtained in the case of such persons who are employed by the Philippines or any Municipal or Provincial Government thereof.

ARTICLE XXIX "

TERM OF AGREEMENT

The present Agreement shall enter into force upon its acceptance " by the two Governments and shall remain in force for a period of ninety-nine years subject to extension thereafter as agreed by the two Governments.

Signed in Manila, Philippines, in duplicate this fourteenth day of March, nineteen hundred and forty seven.

On behalf of the Government of the United States of America:

Paul V. McNutt

[SEAL]

*Ambassador, Extraordinary and Plenipotentiary of the
United States of America to the Republic of the
Philippines*

On behalf of the Government of the Republic of the Philippines:

Manuel Roxas [SEAL]

President of the Philippines

ANNEX A

Clark Field Air Base, Pampanga. Fort
Stotsenberg, Pampanga.

Mariveles Military Reservation, POL Terminal and Training Area, Bataan. Camp
John Hay Leave and Recreation Center, Baguio.

Army Communications System with the deletion of all stations in the Port of

Manila Area.

United States Armed Forces Cemetery No. 2, San Francisco del Monte, Rizal.
Angeles General Depot, Pampanga.

Leyte-Samar Naval Base including shore installations and air bases.

Subic Bay, Northwest Shore Naval Base, Zambales Province, and the existing
Naval reservation at Olongapo and the existing Baguio Naval Reservation.

Tawi Tawi Naval Anchorage and small adjacent land areas.
Canacao-Sangle Point Navy Base, Cavite Province.

Bagobantay Transmitter Area, Quezon City, and associated radio receiving
and control sites, Manila Area.

Tarumpitao Point (Loran Master Transmitter Station), Palawan. Talampulan
Island, Coast Guard fi354 (Loran) , Palawan.

Naule Point (Loran Station) , Zambales.
Castillejos, Coast Guard Q356, Zambales.

ANNEX B

Mactan Island Army and Navy Air Base.

Florida Blanca Air Base, Pampanga.

Aircraft Service Warning Net.

Camp Wallace, San Fernando, La Union.

Puerto Princesa Army and Navy Air Base, including Navy Section Base and Air Warning Sites, Palawan.

Tawi Tawi Naval Base, Sulu Archipelago. Aparri Naval Air Base.

EXCHANGES OF NOTES

The American Ambassador to the Secretary of Foreign Affairs

EMBASSY OF THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA

March 14, 1947

EXCELLENCY

I have the honor to state, in signing the Agreement of March 14, 1947, Between the United States of America and the Republic of the Philippines Concerning Military Bases, the understanding of my Government that the question of the adjustment of any rights and titles held by the United States pursuant to the provisions of the Act of Congress of March 24, 1934 (48 Stat. 456) as amended, specifically Section 10(b) thereof, the Joint Resolution of the Congress of June 29, 1944, and the Act of Congress of July 3, 1946, and Treaties and Agreements heretofore entered into between the United States and the Philippines, to real property in any of the bases covered by the aforementioned Agreement or any naval reservations or fueling stations not so covered is reserved and will be settled subsequently in accordance with the terms of the Acts and Joint Resolution of the Congress mentioned above.

I should be appreciative if I might be informed of the concurrence of Your Excellency's Government with the understanding above set forth.

Accept, Excellency, the renewed assurances of my highest consideration.

PAUL V. McNUTT

His Excellency

ELPIDIO QUIRINO

*Secretary of Foreign Affairs for the
Republic of the Philippines*

The Secretary of Foreign Affairs to the American Ambassador

REPUBLIC OF THE
PHILIPPINES DEPARTMENT OF
FOREIGN AFFAIRS

MANILA, *March 14, 1947*

EXCELLENCY :

With reference to Your Excellency's note of March 14, 1947, the substantive paragraph of which reads:

[For text, see above.]

I have the honor to state that, without conceding the existence of any rights or titles to the real property therein referred to, my Government concurs with the understanding above set forth.

Accept, Excellency, the renewed assurances of my highest consideration.

ELPIDIO QUIRINO
*Vice-President and concurrently
Secretary of Foreign Affairs*

His Excellency

PAUL V. McNUTT
*United States Ambassador
Manila*

The American Ambassador to the Secretary of Foreign Affairs

EMBASSY OF THE
UNITED STATES OF AMERICA

March 14, 1947

EXCELLENCY :

I have the honor to state in signing the Agreement of March 14, 1947 Between the United States of America and the Republic of the Philippines Concerning Military Bases, the understanding of my Government that the garrisoning and development of the said bases shall be the concern of the Government of the United States of America.

I shall be appreciative if I may be informed of the concurrence of Your Excellency's Government with the understanding above set forth.

Accept, Excellency, the renewed assurances of my highest consideration.

PAUL V. McNUTT

His Excellency

ELPIDIO QUIRINO

*Secretary of Foreign Affairs for the
Republic of the Philippines*

The Secretary of Foreign Affairs to the American Ambassador

Republic of the Philippines
Department of Foreign Affairs

MANILA, *March 14, 1947*

EXCELLENCY :

In reply to your note of even date regarding the garrisoning and development of the bases covered by the Agreement of March 14, 1947, between the Republic of the Philippines and the United States of America concerning military bases, I have the honor to state that it is the understanding of my Government that the question of garrisoning and development of said bases shall be the concern of the Government of the United States.

Accept, Excellency, the renewed assurances of my highest consideration.

ELPIDIO QUIRINO

*Vice-President and concurrently
Secretary of Foreign Affairs*

His Excellency

PAUL V. McNUTT

*American Ambassador to the Philippines
Manila*

The Secretary of Foreign Affairs to the American Ambassador

REPUBLIC OF THE PHILIPPINES
DEPARTMENT OF FOREIGN AFFAIRS

MANILA *March 14, 1947*

EXCELLENCY:

In the signing of the Agreement on March 14, 1947, between the Republic of the Philippines and the United States of America concerning military bases, I have the honor to state that it is the understanding of my Government that the existing national and provincial and other rights of way of the Republic of the Philippines running through the bases covered in Annex A and Annex B of the Agreements if tore particularly the

national road running through Camp John Hay and the naval reservation at Baguio, shall continue to be used as such by the public and that this understanding shall be administratively brought about in the enforcement of said Agreement.

I will highly appreciate it, therefore, if I can be informed of the concurrence of Your Excellency's Government with the understanding set forth above.

Accept, Excellency, the renewed assurances of my highest consideration.

ELPIDIO QUIRINO

*Vice-President and concurrently Secretary
of Foreign Affairs*

His Excellency

PAUL N. McNUTT

United States Ambassador

Manila

The American Ambassador to the Secretary of Foreign Affairs

EMBASSY OF THE
UNITED STATES OF AMERICA

March 14, 1947

EXCELLENCY

With reference to Your Excellency's note of March 14, 1947, the substantive paragraph of which reads:

(For text, see above.)

I have the honor to state that without conceding the existence of any national or provincial or other rights of way of the Republic of the Philippines running through any of the bases covered in Annex A and Annex B of the Agreement and subject to such adjustments in rights of way as may be required by military necessity in accordance with paragraph 3 of Article III, my Government concurs with the understanding above set forth.

Accept, Excellency, the renewed assurances of my highest consideration.

PAUL V. McNUTT

His Excellency

ELPIDIO QUIRINO

Secretary of Foreign Affairs for the

Republic of the Philippines

**Official Program of the Inauguration of President Elpidio Quirino and Vice President
Fernando Lopez. Accessed: December 8, 2020**

S o u r c e : <https://ia801302.us.archive.org/13/items/OfficialProgramoftheInaugurationofPresidentElpidioQuirino/19491230-Quirino.pdf>.

This document is a copy of the Official Program of President Elpidio Quirino's inauguration on December 30, 1949 at Luneta, Manila. Quirino was a Lawyer who entered politics as a Representative of Ilocos Sur from 1919 to 1925. He was then elected as Senator from 1925 to 1931. He was a member of the convention that drafted the 1935 Constitution and served as Secretary of Interior and Finance during the Commonwealth period. In 1946, he was elected as Vice President. In 1948, he succeeded the presidency after the death of Manuel Roxas. He won the Presidency in the 1949 elections and completed his term until 1953.

This program contains details with historical importance. The first interesting detail is the cover of the souvenir program designed by Fernando Amorsolo who then was a member of the Inaugural Sub-Committee on Program. In the cover is a young man holding the Filipino flag -- representing the young Philippine Republic and the people who are "ready and determined to serve, labor and produce in order to maintain, protect and defend the infant Republic." The Program also contains biographies of President Elpidio Quirino and Ms. Victoria Quirino, the President's daughter who served as the First Lady; and Vice President Fernando Lopez and his wife, Mrs. Marquita Lopez. There are also excerpts from speeches of the past Philippine Presidents and illustrations of different political personalities during important historical events.

Excerpt:

Schedule of Events

IN CONNECTION WITH THE INAUGURAL CEREMONIES

Thursday, December 29, 1949—

8:00 o'clock p.m.— Popular Inaugural Dance at Plaza Miranda, Quiapo, under the auspices of the City of Manila.

Friday, December 30, 1949

9:30 o'clock a.m.— Assembly of participants and the general public at the Luneta.

10:30 o'clock a.m.— Officials and distinguished guests will take their seats in the Inaugural Grandstand.

10:50 o'clock a.m.— The President and the Vice President will leave Malacañan Palace and will proceed to the Inaugural Grounds.

11:00 o'clock a.m.— Arrival of the President and the Vice President at the Inaugural Grounds.

1:05 o'clock a.m.— Salute to the National Flag.

11:10 o'clock a.m.— Military Parade begins.

11:65 o'clock a.m.— Inaugural ceremonies begin.

12:00 o'clock noon— Oath taking of the President.

12:05 o'clock p.m.— Oath taking of the Vice President.

12:10 o'clock p.m.— Inaugural address of the President.

5:00, o'clock—6:00 o'clock p.m.— Concert at the Inaugural Grandstand, Luneta, by the First Armed Forces Band, Major Antonino Buenaventura, conducting.

8:00 o'clock—10:00 o'clock p.m.—Fireworks at the Luneta.

9:00 o'clock p.m.—Inaugural Reception given by the President and Miss Quirino at Malacañan Palace.

[Page Thirty-four]

Admission by Invitation Only—Vehicles

Admission to the Inaugural Grandstand will be by invitation.

Only vehicles bearing a special automobile pass will be permitted to enter the Inaugural Grounds. All other vehicles will be excluded therefrom until after the conclusion of the ceremonies.

[Page Thirty-five]

Place of Assembly

9:30 o'clock a.m.—

Participants in the Military Parade will assemble at the places assigned to them.

The Inaugural Grandstand will be opened to the guests with admission cards.

The general public will assemble at the places designated for them.

10:00 o'clock a.m.—

Officials and distinguished guests with assigned seats will assemble at the rear of the Inaugural Grandstand.

10:30 o'clock a.m.—

Officials and distinguished guests will proceed to the Inaugural Grandstand to occupy their respective seats.

[Page Thirty—six]

PLACE OF ASSEMBLY...

10:50 o'clock a.m.—

ARRIVAL OF THE PRESIDENT

The President and the Vice President-elect will leave Malacañan Palace, preceded by a military escort of the Armed Forces of the Philippines and will proceed to the Inaugural Grandstand.

11:00 o'clock a.m.—

The arrival at the Inaugural Grounds of the following officials will be announced by a bugle call which will be the signal for the public to rise:

The Vice President—elect of the Philippines

The President of the Philippines

(Upon the appearance of the President of the Philippines four ruffles and four flourishes will be sounded, and a twenty-one gun salute rendered in his honor.)

11:05 o'clock a.m.

SALUTE TO THE NATIONAL FLAG

(Before the President and the Vice President—elect ascend the ceremonial platform, a salute to the flag will be rendered with the First Armed Forces Band playing the Philippine National Anthem.)

11:10 o'clock a.m.—

MILITARY PARADE

A bugle call will be sounded to announce the start of the parade to be reviewed by the President of the Philippines.

ORDER OF UNITS

GRAND MARSHAL

Mai. Gen. MARIANO N. CASTAÑEDA
Chief of Staff, Armed Forces of the Philippines

The Armed Forces of the Philippines

Philippine Military Academy

Philippine Ground Force

Philippine Constabulary

Philippine Air Force

Philippine Naval Patrol

[Page Thirty—seven]

Inaugural Ceremonies

11:55 o'clock a.m.—

1. Invocation by His Grace, Mons. GABRIEL M. REYES,
D. D., Archbishop of Manila.

12:00 o'clock noon—

2. Administration of the Oath of Office to His

Excellency ELPIDIO QUIRINO, President of the Philippines,
by the Chief Justice of the Supreme Court.

(The public will rise and will remain standing throughout the oath-taking ceremonies of the President and the Vice President. The public will be seated upon the commencement of the President's inaugural address.)

The oath-taking of the President of the Philippines will be preceded by ruffles and flourishes, and the playing of the Philippine National Anthem.)

3. Administration of the Oath of Office to the
Honorable FERNANDO LOPEZ, Vice President—elect, by
the Chief Justice of the Supreme Court.

4. Inaugural address by His Excellency ELPIDIO
QUIRINO, President of the Philippines.

5. The Philippine National Anthem.

[Page Thirty-eight]

Recession

12:45 o'clock p.m.—

Upon the conclusion of the Inaugural Ceremonies, the following
officials will retire in the order indicated below:

*(The public will rise and will remain standing until after the officials named
hereunder shall have left)*

The PRESIDENT, of the Republic of the Philippines

The VICE PRESIDENT of the Republic of the Philippines

The PRESIDENT and MEMBERS of the Senate

The PRESIDENT and MEMBERS of the House of Representatives

The CHIEF JUSTICE and ASSOCIATE JUSTICES of the Supreme Court of the
Philippines

The MEMBERS of the Cabinet and the Council of State

The DIPLOMATIC CORPS and their Staffs

[Page Thirty-nine]

Address of President Macapagal on Independence Day, June 12, 1964

Source:<https://www.officialgazette.gov.ph/1964/06/12/address-of-president-macapagal-on-independence-day-june-12-1964/>

Diosdado Macapagal (1910-1997) was a lawyer and statesman. He served as the president of the Philippines from 1961 to 1965.

One of his known actions under his administration was the shift of the observance of the date of the Independence Day from July 4 to June 12, the date when the first Philippine Republic proclaimed its independence. The excerpt contains Macapagal's view that an unrelenting struggle for freedom throughout the history of the Philippine nation was acknowledged in the change of the independence date and continued in the plight to seek the fullness of freedom through socio-economic development and agrarian reform.

Address of President Macapagal on Independence Day, June 12, 1964

THE FULLNESS OF FREEDOM

PRESIDENT MACAPAGAL'S INDEPENDENCE DAY ADDRESS AT THE

LUNETTA, JUNE 12, 1964

THREE years ago today, we commenced the celebration of our day of freedom on the 12th day of June. We made the change not out of a diminution of esteem for America but out of a sense of fidelity to the verities of history. We have since commemorated the 4th of July as American-Philippine Friendship Day, also out of a sense of reality and truth. For it is a reality and a truth, indeed, one of the marvels in the annals of colonialism that after the ties of sovereignty were torn asunder between the United States and the Philippines on July 4, 1946, following forty-eight years of colonial association, instead of the relations between the two countries since then suffering a loosening, the bonds of friendship and partnership between the United States and the Philippines in defense of their security and in support of common ideals have become firmer and stronger with the passing of time.

The history of the Filipino people is an epic of an unrelenting struggle for freedom. Centuries ago, our forebears sailed in frail vintas to settle in our islands in order to escape from the despotism of their rulers in their aboriginal homes. In 1521, the European navigators led by Magellan reached our shores. Upon learning that the strangers came to place our land under the rule of Spain, our people under the Filipino patriot, Lapu-Lapu, fought to resist foreign rule,

resulting in the death of Magellan in the hands of Lapu-Lapu in the battle of Mactan. Finally succumbing to the power of superior arms and brought under the rule of the Spanish crown, the people revolted intermittently and incessantly during the whole period of the one hundred and seventy-seven years of Spanish rule until finally a nationwide revolution led by General Emilio Aguinaldo and the founder of the secret revolutionary society, the Katipunan, Andres Bonifacio, under the inspiration of the Filipino hero and martyr, Dr. Jose Rizal, exploded and succeeded, resulting in the proclamation of Philippine independence in Kawit, Cavite, on June the 12, 1898, by General Aguinaldo and in the establishment of the Philippine Republic under a Constitution adopted in Malolos, Bulacan, with Aguinaldo as President of the Republic.

At about this time, war broke out between the United States and Spain. Defeated in the war, Spain ceded in the Treaty of Peace to the United States the Philippines over which it had lost physical control. Again, the Filipino people resisted the implantation of American rule but were subdued by superior arms with the capture of Aguinaldo in Palanan, Isabela, in 1901. Despite the magnanimity of American rule, the Filipino people continued the struggle for freedom for forty-eight years on the battlefield of peace under a new triumvirate of great Filipino political leaders, Manuel Quezon, Sergio Osmeña, and Manuel Roxas, until on July 4, 1946, the United States proclaimed, restored, and recognized the independence of the Filipino people as a free and sovereign nation.

With the recognition of political independence in 1946, the centuries-old struggle of our people for freedom did not come to an end. What has been won so far is political freedom, which carries the sovereign right to choose the way of life under which our people desire to live. Political freedom is not an end in itself but a means to a greater end, for which our people are now called upon to continue their unfinished struggle—their unfinished revolution—for freedom. That greater end is economic freedom which would extend political freedom to the economic life of the people and which requires the liberation of the national economy from foreign dominance and above all, which demands the freedom from bondage to poverty and misery of the greatest number of our people.

This is the new and continuing struggle for freedom in which our people are engaged today. It seeks goals different from those sought in the military revolution of Aguinaldo and Bonifacio or from those sought by the peaceful revolution for political independence of Quezon, Osmeña, and Roxas. It seeks the readjustment and rectification of those conditions created in our society during four hundred twenty-five years of colonial status that do not conform to the spirit, idealism, and soul of the Filipino nation, to the end that the bounty which God in His generosity showered upon our land shall not be a monopoly of a privileged few but shall be shared by the greatest number of our countrymen.

By its nature, this is a difficult endeavor as, indeed, all revolutions, violent or peaceful, are difficult endeavors. But it is a task that is inescapable and must be undertaken if we are to be faithful to the legacy of freedom for which our forebears paid with their sacrifice and their blood.

There is one condition *sine qua* in this continued revolutionary struggle for economic freedom. It must be sought only through the ways of freedom. It must be so because since it is freedom in its fullness which our people have sought and fought for through generations and centuries, it would be an unpardonable monstrosity to seek that economic freedom through totalitarianism and not through the processes of liberty.

Our national endeavor therefore is a search for the fullness of freedom through the medium of freedom. Thus, under the aegis of this freedom, we have striven with increasing effectiveness to eradicate the evil of graft and corruption that has held sway in our government and among our people during the last sixteen years since the war's end through a moral regeneration program that respects due process and the rule of law.

We have discarded a twelve-year system of economic controls to restore the freedom of our currency. By this step, we have strengthened and stabilized the value of the Philippine peso and, in addition, the measure has immediately raised the income of the exporters, producers, and dependents of sugar, copra, abaca, minerals, palay, and other products of agriculture, industry, and mining.

We have launched land reform to give freedom and land to the tillers of our farms after centuries of economic and social bondage. The implementation of the land reform program will commence this month in Plaridel, Bulacan, and thereafter will be expanded to other parts of Central Luzon and other affected parts of the country. In this measure, we have limited its applicability to land of at least 75 hectares in area, and we have provided for freedom of choice to the affected landowners to shift voluntarily their capital to industry.

We have launched a five-year socio-economic development program on the basis of free enterprise to extend freedom to our masses from the generations-old slavery to poverty by promoting investments and production in industry, agriculture, and mining which would provide inadequate measure the needs of our fast-increasing population.

Indicative of the effectiveness of this program, production in agriculture, industry, and mining in 1963 started to exceed the production in 1961 and continues to expand.

We have invigorated the execution of an extensive program of public works, including concrete highways, rural roads, ports, and airfields, to give support and impetus to the establishment of factories and other productive ventures by private enterprises.

We have given specific boost to tourism as a feature of our economic program. The successful prospect of this undertaking is shown by the establishment at least, after many years of futile encouragement in the past, of a ₱20 million Manila Hilton Hotel which will place our accommodations for tourists at par with the highest world standards.

Realizing that liberation from bondage to the poverty of generations through our socio-economic program will require some time, we have in the meantime endeavored to insure our people against critical want by assuring at all times the rice and corn which is their food at reasonable prices while assuring profits to the palay growers. We have assured that the people have ready access to low-cost fish and other prime commodities, and we have provided ready job opportunities for those in critical need of income.

We are selling the lots and houses of the People's Home-site and Housing Corporation to their occupants to which they previously only had leasehold rights, and we have built multi-storey tenements for the virtual indigents to give them freedom from a sense of homelessness.

We have given free lots to the inhabitants of a large part of military land to satisfy their aspiration to own the lots on which their homes are built, as their forbears had yearned to do for a hundred years.

We have given particular support and assistance to the textile and garments industries to provide decent and inexpensive clothing to our population.

We have sold a multi-million government textile factory to its workers to usher them to freedom from the drudgery of endless labor into the threshold of proprietorship.

We have joined in an earnest coalition with the Labor Party to insure the legitimate effort of the workers to safeguard their rights and pursue their welfare in the widest latitude of freedom and justice.

While giving our people these urgent services, we have at the same time moved towards stable abundance by seeking the establishment by statute of a Rice and Corn Authority to attain self-sufficiency in rice and corn by establishing the Fisheries Commission to increase our fish supply, and by effectively promoting basic investments that would create permanent job opportunities.

Among the investments which show the success of the program are the ₱450 million integrated steel plant in Iligan City, the ₱250 million pulp and paper factory in Bislig, Surigao, the ₱80 million banana establishment in Davao, the ₱80 million canned pineapple plant in Cotabato, the ₱60 million steel plate plant in Binangonan, Rizal, the ₱120 million fertilizer plant in Bataan, and others too numerous for exhaustive mention.

To assure to our youth freedom from ignorance we have avoided the recurrent school crises and have embarked on massive construction of new school buildings. We have likewise sought from Congress the establishment of a Workers' University to give an opportunity to the deserving children of the poorest families to acquire university education.

We have respected with full understanding and without reprisal the freedom of the press and other media to criticize the Administration to the verge of license because we espouse the

principle that, given a choice between licentious freedom and its regulation, we are for the former because freedom possesses a quality of self-discipline that can remove its excesses while regulation may amount to regimentation that can lead to tyranny.

We have cooperated in the freedom of our political adversaries not only to criticize the Administration but also to conduct investigations against the actions of executive officials believing that it is through free inquiries that the truth of the indictment can be established or its falsity exposed.

Without diminishing our ties with our closest ally, the United States, we have charted a wider course of freedom in dealing with other nations and in particular with our brothers in the Afro-Asian community.

To carry out our program of prosperous life for our people in freedom, we have set the basic requirement of peace in the country by dealing the communist uprising a mortal blow through the capture of its “brain,” Dr. Jesus Lava.

The final capture of Lava after eluding the authorities for eighteen years is not only a historic but significant event. Lava led a (movement that sought substantially the same economic freedom that we seek for our masses, but he sought his goals through the tactics of totalitarianism, tyranny, and violence that characterize communism. Upon his capture, he acknowledged that in our current efforts under our system of democracy, social conditions have improved and fresh hopes have been raised for the common man. It would not be far-fetched to believe that it was this dismay in the success of our democratic efforts for the welfare of our people which weakened the fervor of the communist cause and Lava’s own will to continue his violent uprising, thereby resulting in his capture after years of fugitive elusiveness.

The capture of Lava, therefore, should focus our minds on two things: firstly, that our struggle to achieve a better life for the multitudes of our people through the ways of freedom is proving to be the right course; therefore, thus encouraged, we can reassure our people that as long as we have the responsibility of steering the affairs and destiny of our nation, we shall endeavor to build a better country and a better life for our people not through any techniques of totalitarianism but through the established Filipino way of life—through peace, freedom, and the rule of law.

Secondly, it should be food for thought to those who now enjoy in greater measure than others the bounty of our land that for the sake of our country and for their own sake, they ought to view with greater understanding and even support our energetic efforts to provide effective opportunities to the greatest number to attain a better life through the ways of peace, freedom, and the rule of law because this is the course that will avoid the tragedy that has befallen other nations—including nations around us—in which the inescapable struggle of the masses to share in the wealth of their country has been accomplished in the manner in which Lava and his movement would wish it to be achieved, through totalitarianism, tyranny, and violence, under

which not only wealth and comfort but life itself stands in danger of being lost. The affluent in our society should not ignore or forget these early the warnings and lessons of our recent history, when the alternative of violent protest rather than peaceful reform pursued by the communists almost succeeded in overwhelming us and, destroying the sources of their wealth and fortunes.

To expand the area of basic peace upon which we pursue a prosperous and free life for our people, we have sought to use our good offices to prevent tension and conflict in our international neighborhood. To this end, after our independence ceremonies, much as I do not wish to leave our country at this time, I shall be constrained to fly to Tokyo to undertake this vital (mission. It is an hazardous mission that involves our national interest and that seeks for ourselves and our neighbors freedom from war. I need the good wishes of all in this momentous undertaking, for if it fails it will jeopardize the stability of our region; but if it succeeds, it will mean not only peace in our neighborhood but an initiative in international diplomacy that will bring honor to our entire nation.

In summation, our commemoration of our day of freedom is, therefore, not an empty ceremony but is a realistic ritual of rededication to the substance of our lives and our aspirations as a people which consists in the fullness of freedom. Our celebration and jubilation on the day of our independence is as essential a part of our lives, as individuals and as a nation, as the air that we breathe, the food that we eat, and the God whom we worship.

I need but make one more observation to end this speech. The struggle for freedom, whether political or economic, is truly a revolution. In other lands, it has become a violent revolution. In our country, we are lucky thus far that our revolution for a better economic life has been a peaceful one. But whether violent or peaceful, all revolutions demand sacrifice and fortitude in the face of transitory hardship. If we are worthy of freedom, if we are worthy of the sacrifice and fortitude of our heroes who left us a legacy of freedom, if we are worthy of the better life that we seek for ourselves, if we possess the manhood of a virile nation, let us not whimper in the face of transient hardship, let us not wail over inconvenience and difficulty. Rather, as good citizens, let us do our share in this common struggle ready to sacrifice and to undergo hardship; let us work hard together, for this is the way to build a richer nation in free enterprise; let us realize that it is necessary for us to undergo the cavalry of sacrifice and hard work in order to deserve and enjoy the redemption of a better and happier life.

I end with the proud declaration of the truth that the Philippines is irrevocably a land of freedom. The love for freedom is the outstanding trait of the Filipino. Democracy and the freedom on which our government is founded have taken firm and very deep roots not only in the soil of our earth but also in the soul of our people. Having espoused peace, freedom, and the rule of law as their way of life, the Filipinos will rather die fighting for freedom than live under any tyranny, foreign or native. Because freedom is his devout wish on this independence day, the Filipino feels inside him that his freedom is still incomplete. There will never be the fullness of freedom that the Filipino heart yearns for until it includes as a reality freedom from want, freedom from poverty, freedom from misery, freedom from a hopeless life of hardship and deprivation. As the

leaders of two preceding generations before us contributed their share essentially in the political sphere to the achievement of our people's goal of freedom in its fullness, its expansion to the freedom of our multitudes from social and economic bondage to poverty is the task of our own generation. This is the inescapable task of all of us. On my part, with God's benediction, I shall do my share of the enormous task the best way I know how.

May God bless our people on this our day of freedom so that it shall become full and shall last unto eternity.

Romulo, Carlos P. “Crusade in Asia” pp. 125 – 127. in *Romulo Reader*. Edited by Liana Romulo. Makati: Bookmark, 1998. Excerpt also available on

Source: https://archive.org/stream/crusadeinasiaphi006144mbp/crusadeinasiaphi006144mbp_djvu.txt

Carlos P. Romulo (1898 – 1985) was an intellectual and the country’s topmost diplomat, having served as the secretary for foreign affairs under the presidencies of Quirino, Macapagal and Marcos. His track record in the United Nations, serving as one-time president of its General Assembly, showed that he was among the few Filipinos during the postwar period who made an impact in setting an agenda for international relations and global cooperation.

This document is an excerpt from Romulo’s resignation as the Ambassador of the Philippines to the United States, and concurrent the Permanent Delegate to the United Nations in 1953. The select sections of the document shows Romulo’s reason that a change of leadership is needed within the government. As of the writing of this letter, President Quirino was considering running for a second term, and Romulo, after having conversations with Quirino and reflections on the state of the country, Romulo made his resignation to his post in order to address the clamor for a change in leadership. This letter shows Romulo’s resolve to resign for his post as his personal way to preserve the future of the emerging newly independent state through a renewed change in moral leadership.

Excerpt:

My letter of resignation to His Excellency Elpidio Quirino, President of the Philippines, written on May 14, 1953, reads, in part, as follows:

DEAR MR. PRESIDENT:

On board the Apo on May 1, the evening following my return to Manila at your behest, you spoke to me frankly about the reasons why you have decided to seek the nomination of our party

for the second term. I informed you then that in my considered opinion it would be desirable in the national interest that you reconsider your decision

to seek another term.

This statement rests upon the sober, impersonal conviction which I have reached that a change in leadership would not only be a good thing for the country at this time but is indeed an essential condition for our future progress.

It also rests upon the equally sober realization that our people profoundly desire such a change. Our people today are weary and confused. If they are not demoralized, it is because of the inherent spiritual power and the unshakable faith -which has distinguished them throughout the ages, through which they have always been able to recruit renewed strength of purpose to overcome the mightiest obstacles to their progress.

Despite the restoration of a degree of economic stability, economic difficulties among our masses have been mounting. Economic inequalities have become more noticeable. These, with their natural concomitant's political confusion, social decay and above all, a noticeably growing lack of public confidence in government have created a situation of grave national peril that is unprecedented in our history, and that has brought deep concern to all thinking men who have been witnesses of these phenomena.

It has not been easy for me, Mr. President, to reach the conclusion that has been forced on me by factors and stresses visible to so many of our countrymen, that our people are in a deep discontent under a burden of woes and grievances.

These considerations have compelled me to the conclusion that the time has come for a salutary and necessary change in the leadership of our national life one which will remove from the palate of our people the stale taste of promises unfulfilled, or failures, and will provide the people with fresh resolve and inspiration, based on a reinvigorated faith in government.

And here lies the crux of the present specific political situation, the implication of which candor compels me to note for your consideration. It cannot have escaped you that bitter feelings have

been engendered: and it is my conviction, shared by many, that a supreme gesture by you a gesture not so much of self-abnegation as of a vision that rises above the level of the moderately enlightened would act to dissolve these feelings in a solvent of national good will and understanding, and would avert consequences which you would be the first to deplore.

Such an act on your part, all circumstances considered, would shine as an act of enlightened statesmanship and patriotism, would constitute a heartening recognition of our democracy's inherent capacity for renewal, and would establish you in a position of high moral leadership and influence 'which no mere political effort could give.

I have addressed this letter to you in complete candor, out of a sense of patriotic duty. To tell you the unvarnished truth is, I believe, the highest form of service that I can render the party now. What happens to me personally is a matter of little consequence. It is the future of our country that is paramount. On this, I am certain, we agree.

I am cognizant of the fact that by suggesting, as I do now, that you forbear, in the national interest, from seeking nomination or election for another term, I am creating

a situation in which you may feel that I no longer am capable of that complete meeting of minds which would make my continuance as your Ambassador to the United States, and Permanent Delegate to the United Nations, possible.

For this reason I hereby have the honor to place in your hands my resignation from both posts.

Sincerely yours,

CARLOS P. ROMULO

Address of President Macapagal on Independence Day, August 8, 1963.

Source:<https://www.officialgazette.gov.ph/1963/08/08/address-of-president-macapagal-at-the-signing-of-the-agricultural-land-reform-code/>

One of the most well-known accomplishments of President Macapagal is agrarian land reform through the enactment of the Republic Act No. 3844 or Agricultural Land Reform Code. The Agricultural Land Reform Code provided the establishment of a leasehold system between landlords and farmers which sought an end to the tenancy system that had been the prevailing system. The law also provided the authority to acquire and distribute agrarian land equitably as well as created a financial institution for such acquisition and distribution.

In this document, President Macapagal signed into law this agrarian land reform program with him proclaiming that this was the culmination of the freedom of farmers. Through a historical overview of the struggles of the farmers from the colonial times to the independent state, the land reform code, according to Macapagal, served as a triumph not only to free the farmer from the oppressive system but to enable him to invigorate productive agriculture for the economy of the nation-state.

EXCERPT:

Address of President Macapagal at the signing of the Agricultural Land Reform Code

August 8, 1963

Address

of

His Excellency Diosdado Macapagal

President of the Philippines

At the Signing of the Agricultural Land Reform Code

[Delivered on August 8, 1963]

AN ACT OF EMANCIPATION

WE ARE GATHERED here to witness a very simple act. The act itself will take no more than a few seconds, no more than a brief moment to affix a simple signature on the last page of a printed document. It will take no more than a few quick strokes of the hand. Yet in this brief moment are packed many centuries. This unspectacular act of signing a piece of paper will bring to an end a long and at times bitter past of economic and human slavery which we now make bold to abolish, and it will launch a new and better future for those languishing in poverty from this bondage which we now make bold to build.

There have been times in human history when a short signature by a mortal hand could build or demolish empires, or send nations at war with one another. Today, a signature by a humble hand obedient to a million silent aspirations will give the toiling Filipino farmer his liberation from poverty and social degradation. Thus, we are gathered here not merely to observe a transitory ceremony; we are engaged in the formidable act of re-making history. We are presiding over the dismantlement of an institution that has plagued our land for longer than four and a half centuries. We are celebrating the initial step that will burst us under the forces and the institutions that have kept our tenants in silent bondage over a period of time that extends to long before the Spaniards came to our shores. We are returning to our toiling farmer the freedom that is his by God's grace, the dignity and security that come with the possession of his own land, and the natural right to enjoy the rewards of his own labors. We are launching the boldest program of land reform ever attempted in our country which shall bring redemption to the economic slaves tilling our farms.

In a few minutes, we shall sign an enactment of Congress proposed by us into law. But we are signing more than an ordinary code. We are signing a veritable proclamation of independence, a declaration of faith, a declaration of determination. By this we proclaim the independence of the shackled Filipino farmer, declare our faith in his ability to fulfill the responsibility that comes with his newly won freedom, and declare our determination to assist him effectively in rising to the proud status of an owner of his land and the equal in human dignity of any other citizen of the land.

This occasion is the culmination of more than four hundred and fifty years of history of tenancy in the Philippines. It was mostly a melancholy history; at times, it was a turbulent history. It was a continuous history of share-cropping and debt-peonage that bore down on the shoulders of the tenant, whether it be the mamamahay of pre-Hispanic times or the kasamahan farmer who emerged in the eighteenth century or the share tenant of the twentieth century. Some of the old Spanish governors-general tried to alleviate the plight of the mamamahay, but their attempts took the form of laws that were not honored in practice. In the eighteenth century Jose Basco y Vargas made another attempt at liberating the tenant from his servitude by prohibiting practice of kasamahan, except in the case of landlords who had some legitimate reasons for absenteeism; such as sickness or old age.

All through the American occupation of the Philippines and all through the Commonwealth period the problem of the tenant was a profound concern. Some advocates of reform sought the way of violent uprisings, strikes, or similar massive actions by tenants against landlords: Benigno Ramos led his Sakdals, and Pedro Abad Santos, his Socialists. Others, resorting to the methods of law, pushed the passage of measures to improve the lot of the tenants by increasing his share of the crop or by giving him tenure or by resettling him on friar or public lands. President Manuel Quezon announced and tried to pursue a program of social justice in an effort to pioneer in land reform.

In 1946, after the war and after the transfer of political sovereignty back to the Philippines, another tenancy law, Republic Act 34, was passed. Again it regulated sharing arrangements, protected the tenant from undue eviction, and defined the rights and obligations of tenants and landlords within a system of share-tenancy.

Still another attempt at land reform, and the boldest one before this new law, was taken by President Ramon Magsaysay. Under his administration Congress passed Republic Act 1400 in 1955. It was salutary in its intentions, but—in spite of its ambition—it suffered from the weaknesses of its predecessors: it attacked the tenancy system on the surface, not at the roots. The evidence of the failure of past intentions are all around us. Today we have more share-tenants than ever before. The trend is firmly established and shows no signs of levelling off, unless fundamental measures are implemented. Even in resettlement projects which have for their entire objective the establishment of farmer-operators tilling their own farms, the corrosive forces of share-tenancy have penetrated and are spreading rapidly.

This trend cannot be stopped except by bold and forthright action. We cannot cure a grave disease by simple palliatives. We cannot remove a growing social tumor by treating its surface. We can remove it only by a quick surgery. The failure of past attempts at land reform was always a failure of determination: they tried to alleviate the pains, the evils, the injustices of the share-tenancy system, rather than resolutely attacking the system itself. The result is that while some of the edges of the problem have been treated with some success, the disease remains as formidable and as threatening as ever.

It is thus not enough to deal with the bits and pieces of the problem. It is not sufficient simply to enlarge the tenant's share of the crop, or to give him stability of tenure, or to outlaw usury, or to provide alternative sources of credit, for the basic disorder remains. All the problems that plague the share-tenant—the death of his initiative, his vulnerability to usury, his weak bargaining position before the landlord and trader, his poverty—all these have one root cause, namely, the very institution of share of share-tenancy itself. This is the very disease that must be removed, decisively and with determination.

Today, with a few strokes of the pen, we shall perform the initial step in this surgery. This document before us, a bill which in a few minutes will become a statute to be known as the Agricultural Land Reform Code, will provide us with the legal powers to remove once and for all the system of share-tenancy that has plagued our agricultural countryside. In one statement it declares share tenancy as violative of the law of the land, a system which will be abolished and will no longer be tolerated by law. But the Code does not only provide us with the powers to remove an organic disease from our agricultural society; it also provides the means of injecting new health, new vigor, new muscles, and new strength into the new social order that will arise. Its first and immediate step is to destroy an oppressive and intolerable system; its ensuing objectives—which will constitute the sinews of land reform—is to nurse our agricultural economy into a state of healthy productivity. It not only aims to turn the Filipino tenant into a free man; it aims, most of all, to turn him into a more productive farmer.

Thus, after centuries of silent struggle and angry protests, the Filipino tenant finds in this movement his victory, finds in this pen a powerful scythe with which to harvest the fruits of a proud and productive future, finds in this gathering the jubilant witnesses of his triumph, finds on this stage a rampart from which to view the wide and spacious fields in the country which shall be his to till, to work, to cultivate, and to love as his own. This moment is only an initial triumph in that the law has torn down his prison. His task from hereon is to build: to build his own technical capabilities, to cultivate his farm efficiently and scientifically; his abilities to finance his operations in an orderly manner, his ability to market his produce effectively, and to invest the savings out of his increased incomes in the further improvement of his own farm. Most of all, his task is to change himself, his outlook, his spirit, his attitude towards work. Under the law he will cease to be a tenant; during a transitional period he will function as a leaseholder; and after a few years he will be a landowner. We call upon him to abandon his outlook as a tenant, and take on the vision of a new landowner.

In this transition the Filipino farmer will need help. As a transitional leaseholder and as an eventual landowner he will need manifold assistance, including technical, marketing, financial, and legal. The Land Reform Code provides the government with the resources and the machinery with which to give him all the help and support he needs. Among these are the Agricultural Productivity Commission which will extend to him technical assistance, the Agricultural Credit Administration which will give him operational financing and marketing assistance, the office of Agrarian Counsel which will provide him legal assistance, the Land Authority which will assist him to become the owner of the land he tills, and the Land Bank which will assist him to pay for the land that has become his own.

Under the Land Reform Program, the farmer will therefore have behind him a formidable battery of government agencies to insure that his transformation from a tenant into a lessee and eventually into a landowner will result in increased production from our farms, in increased incomes for our farmers, in better management of the farmer's financial affairs, and—most of all—in the enhancement of the dignity and the social position of those who now live under the burden of tenancy. Realizing that the implementation of the program is the crux to the realization of its noble objectives, we pledge all our power, all our fervor, and all our faculties to warrant the efficient operation of all these agencies in order to insure the rise of the poverty-enslaved tenant into a free and prosperous farmer.

The machinery for carrying out the Land Reform Program will soon be in full operation. We shall see that the implementation of the program thereby will not be haphazard but systematic; will not be hasty but orderly; will not be reckless but resolute. It will be pursued in manageable stages, rather than as a breathless and one-shot effort that will sweep the nation overnight. It will be managed prudently and well, with all due respect to the rights of all parties concerned.

In abolishing tenancy and launching a decisive and bold land reform program, we confront a huge and monumental task. We dare say that it matches the historic proportions of no other

achievement of our nation in the past, save the Philippine Revolution that began in 1896. Indeed, the Land Reform Program is a revolution in itself, part of the peaceful, ambitious, unfinished revolution which we are now waging to win for our people an adequate measure of prosperity and well-being. Land reform is not a separate and isolated program; it is a component, and a very crucial component, of our wide-ranging and integrated program to promote the rapid and sound social and economic development of our country. Land Reform will release the hitherto suppressed productive energies of our farmers, and will thus increase the capacity of our agricultural sector to provide our people with food and our industries with raw materials. Land reform will increase the incomes of our agricultural society, and will thus convert it into a large market for the produce of our industries. Land reform is not solely a program to help tenants; it is a program to uplift the whole nation, socially and economically. It is ultimately a proof and demonstration of the respect which our nation holds for the dignity and the rights which are attached inseparably to the human person.

It is meet to recall at this point that the Filipino has been associated with apathy and resistance to progress. Our national hero, Dr. Jose Rizal, has referred to this seeing trait as the indolence of the Filipino which must be overcome. For centuries, the Filipino tilling our farms seemed indolent because his creative and constructive qualities were overpowered and stifled by a sense of hopelessness as he languished in the dark prison of his unending poverty and misery. Since life was to him hopeless for advancement, his supreme ambition and recourse for human joy was to spend the occasional windfalls from his lengthening debt in order to drown his sorrows in tuba and basi or in a bet at a cockfight. This sense of hopelessness was a drug that kept him indolent and lukewarm to the charms of progress. Through this land reform program, which releases the tenants from endless darkness to the sunshine of new hopes, we can look forward to the day when the so-called indolent Filipino, after centuries, shall be no more, and in his place will arise a Filipino who shall work hard because he has a better life to work and hope for, who shall actively take part in community work that builds the nation because he has the dignity that makes him the equal of all his countrymen, who shall fight for his rights and do his duties because he has effective freedom for the discharge of this responsibility, and who, in the hour of necessity, will be happy to give even his life for his country because in his country he has land to call his own.

The Filipino farmer has waited century after century for this very moment and this very occasion. In a moment, as the elected President of this Republic, I shall sign the Agricultural Land Reform Code into a law of the land. By this act the nation shall put its indelible seal on this proclamation of the toiling farmer's liberation and his victory.

So let this signing be recorded in our annals as an Act of Emancipation of the toiling farmer from his slavery to debt, poverty, and misery and of his dignification as a human being and as a citizen. By this act of emancipation, a new revolution is on.

In fulfillment of the dream of centuries and in answer to the cry for liberation of the slaved Filipino tenant in our farms from his chains of want and misery, it is now my cherished privilege

and infinite honor to sign the Agricultural Land Reform Code into law as Republic Act No. 3844 on this memorable day of the Common Man.